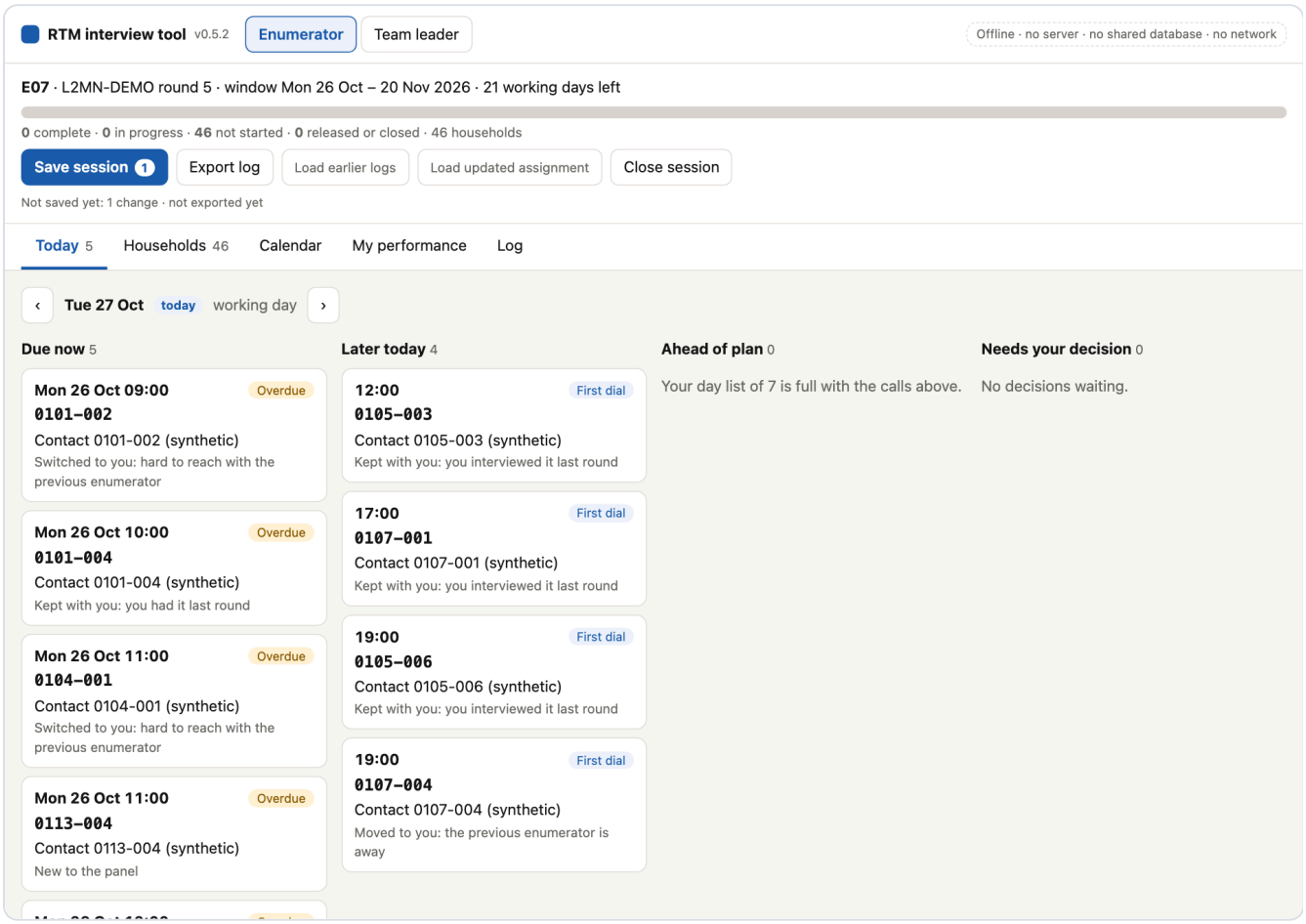
RTM interview tool

User manual for enumerators and team leaders
Assignment, scheduling and call logs for phone panel surveys



Tool version 0.5.2 · Manual of 10 November 2026
Real-Time Monitoring (RTM) Handbook task team. Every picture in this manual shows the synthetic practice program “L2MN-DEMO”: no real household, name or phone number appears anywhere in it.

Contents

Introduction

1 What the tool does

2 Files and folders

3 A round at a glance

4 Before you start

5 The tool with KoBoToolbox

6 The tool with Survey Solutions

Part A · Enumerator

A1 Open your assignment

A2 The screen at a glance

A3 The Today tab

A4 A household's panel

A5 Log a call

A6 The result

A7 Booked callbacks

A8 A complete under 3 minutes

A9 A call logged later

A10 Correct or void an entry

A11 Release, switch or removal

A12 Add or correct a number

A13 Replacements

A14 The Households tab

A15 The Calendar tab

A16 My performance

A17 The Log tab

A18 Save, close and continue

A19 Export your log

A20 An updated assignment

A21 On a phone

A22 Good practice and messages

A23 Move a household's next call

A24 Mark time off

Part B · Team leader

B1 Start or continue a session

B2 The Prepare tab

B3 Step 1 · Household list

B4 Step 2 · Earlier rounds

B5 Step 3 · Replacement list

B6 Step 4 · Round calendar

B7 Step 5 · Team

B8 Step 6 · Assignment rule

B9 Step 7 · Check the assignment

B10 Step 8 · Write and give out the files

B11 Save and close the session

B12 Import the exports

B13 Merge questions and the merge report

B14 New or corrected numbers

B15 Progress

B16 Call log and the round's files

B17 Analytics

B18 Risk lists

B19 A round, step by step

B20 Messages and what to do

Part C · With KoBoToolbox

C1 When this part applies

C2 The Philippines form: one submission per call attempt

C3 A form the tool does not know

C4 A round, day by day

C5 Without a form of its own

C6 What the leader sees

Part D · With Survey Solutions

D1 When this part applies

D2 The tool's own questionnaire

D3 A questionnaire the tool does not know

D4 A round, day by day

D5 What the leader sees

Reference

R1 Call results

R2 Why a household is with an enumerator

R3 Every file the tool reads or writes

Introduction

1 What the tool does

The RTM interview tool is one web page, `rtm_interview_tool.html`, that runs in a web browser on the enumerator's or the leader's own computer. It has two views, chosen with the buttons at the top of the page:

- **Enumerator.** Each enumerator opens the assignment file their leader gave them, works through the calls that are due, logs every dial with its time and result, saves their session, and exports their log.
- **Team leader.** The leader prepares each round: they assign households to enumerators, plan each household's first dial, and write one assignment file per enumerator. During and after the round, they import the enumerators' exports, settle any merge question, and read progress, the merged call log, the round's analytics and the risk lists.

> **Offline by design.** The page has no server, no shared database and no network connection. The browser is told to refuse every request from it. It reads only the files you open and writes only the files you save or export. Nothing leaves your computer unless you move a file yourself.

The tool follows the handbook's practice. The default way of assigning households keeps the same enumerator, rotates a planned share of households each round, and switches the enumerator for a household that becomes hard to reach (Section 3.5.3). Each household's first dial is planned at the hour of its last interview (Section 3.5.2), early in the round's window (Section 3.4). The definitions of a dial, a complete and an enumerator-day are those of Box 3.0.

2 Files and folders

Because nothing is shared over a network, the work moves in files. Three kinds of folder keep them apart:

Folder	Who can read it	What goes in it
The enumerator's own folder	That enumerator and the leader	The enumerator's assignment file, and their saved sessions
The common folder	The whole team	The enumerators' exported logs (`.csv` and `.json`). They hold household IDs, times and results, but no names or phone numbers
The leader's own folder	The leader	The household list, the leader's session, the round's manifest and outputs, contacts files

> **Contact information never goes in the common folder.** An assignment file holds names and phone numbers, but only that enumerator's own households. A contacts file, written when an enumerator adds or corrects a number, goes to the leader directly. The leader's session file holds the whole household list.

3 A round at a glance

1. **The leader prepares the round** (Part B, steps 1 to 8): household list, earlier rounds, replacements, calendar, team, rule. The tool writes one assignment file per enumerator and a manifest of the round.
2. **The leader gives each enumerator their own file**, through a folder only that enumerator can read, with its passphrase if the file is protected.
3. **Enumerators call and log** (Part A). They save their session whenever they stop, and export their log at the end of each day.
4. **The leader imports the exports** whenever they want to see progress, and settles the merge questions.
5. **At the end of the round**, the leader imports the final exports and writes the round's files: the merged call log, `interviews.csv` and `calendar.csv` for the handbook's round template, and the merge report.

4 Before you start

- **Browser.** Open the page in Google Chrome, for example by dragging the file onto a Chrome window. Chrome was used for all the tool's tests. Edge, Firefox and Safari should work but have not been tested. In Chrome a save can overwrite the same file; in Firefox and Safari each save downloads a new file with the time in its name.
- **Practice files.** The folder `samples/` holds the synthetic program L2MN-DEMO used in this manual: assignment files for round 5 in `samples/round05/`, and the leader's inputs and the enumerators' exports in `samples/leader/`. Phone numbers there use the invalid country code +000.
- **Clock.** The tool records times from the computer's clock. Keep it set to the right date, time and time zone.

5 The tool with KoBoToolbox: why, how, who records what, and the files

Why. Every L2 program interviews in KoBoToolbox, and KoBoToolbox does its part well: the form, the answers, the submissions. It has no notion of a round: who should call which household, when each should be dialed first, how many dials a household gets, what happens to a household nobody reaches, who is behind, and what the round's call log looks like for the handbook's measures. That is the tool's side. Used together, the two cover a phone round end to end, with nothing typed twice and no third system.

How. The leader prepares the round in the tool (Part B) and gives the form its list of households. The enumerators interview in the form as before. Each day the leader downloads the form's export and drops it on the **KoBoToolbox** tab (Part C); the tool merges it, shows progress, raises the questions it cannot settle, and lets the leader move households during the round, after which the list is written again. Everything that crosses the boundary is a file: nothing in the tool connects to KoBoToolbox over the network, and nothing in the form changes except its list of households and, once, a filter on the interviewer's code.

Who records what. Each fact is recorded once, in the system that produces it. The one item with a choice is the call attempt, and it must have exactly one home: the handbook's effort measures (dials per complete, the hazard by dial, the best hours) need one row per dial, and an export of interviews alone gives completes only.

What is recorded	Form records each attempt (the Philippines form)	Form records interviews only	Why there
The interview: answers, per-question timings, device, form version, who submitted	KoBoToolbox	KoBoToolbox	The platform makes it; the tool never holds answers
Each call attempt: time, number used, result	The form; the tool reads the export	The tool's enumerator view, or the tool's own one-row-per-call form (C5)	Recorded once; double entry costs calls
Call length	The form's open and submit times, an approximation	Entered by the enumerator with each call (start and minutes), from the phone system	A form opened before the dial overstates the call; the tool places no call
Callbacks booked, releases, corrected numbers	The form, where it asks; otherwise not kept	The tool	They drive the next day's list
The assignment and its reasons, the plan, the calendar, moves and handovers, the leader's decisions	The tool	The tool	No form knows a round, a reassignment or a dial cap
The round's call log in the handbook's columns	The tool, derived from the export	The tool, from its own logs	One table for the analyses, whichever source fed it

The files. Five files cross the boundary, listed below; everything else stays where it was made. The interviews' answers and KoBoToolbox's own paradata stay in the project; the household list with its contacts, the assignment files, the manifest and the leader's session stay with the leader.

File	Made by	What it is for
The form's data export: Data › Downloads › CSV with *XML values and headers*, or the project's export link; one row per submission, every submission so far	KoBoToolbox	Dropped on the KoBoToolbox tab, step 3: read as the round's attempt log, split by interviewer and merged (C2). Keep it in the leader's own folder: it holds the answers
The form itself, as an XLSForm	The program, in KoBoToolbox	Not read by the tool. It fixes the column names and result codes the tool reads; the Philippines form's are built in, any other form's are mapped once (C3)

`choices_households.csv`	The tool, steps 2 and 4	Pasted over the list in the form's choices sheet, then the form is redeployed: each interviewer sees only their households. No phone numbers
`rtm_call_record.xlsx` and `households.csv`	The tool's own form (`formats/kobo/`) and the media file the tool writes, step 2	For a program without a form of its own: one submission per call, the household picked from the media file, which holds the numbers (C5)
`{program}_R{nn}_kobo_review.csv`	The tool, step 5	The submissions behind merge questions, with their `_uuid` , to find in the project's table view

6 The tool with Survey Solutions

A program that interviews in Survey Solutions, the World Bank's survey platform, works with the tool the same way (Part D): Survey Solutions holds the questionnaire, the answers and the review of each interview, and the tool keeps the round. The leader's side is the **Survey Solutions** tab, again in five steps, and again with no network link. The table of section 5 holds, with two differences. Survey Solutions gives work out by *assignment*, so the list that goes out is an assignments upload with each interviewer's login, not a choices list. A move is a reassignment the leader makes in Headquarters, from a list the tool writes, because Survey Solutions has no file for it. Four files cross the boundary:

File	Made by	What it is for
The tabular export (`.zip`): Data Export, Tab separated	Survey Solutions Headquarters	Dropped on the Survey Solutions tab, step 3: the calls, joined to their interviews, split by interviewer and merged (D2, D3). Keep it in the leader's own folder: it holds the answers
`assignments.tab`	The tool, step 2	Uploaded under Survey Setup › Questionnaires › Upload assignments: one assignment per household, the login in `_responsible` . The tool's own questionnaire takes the numbers as identifying fields
`{program}_R{nn}_suso_moves.csv`	The tool, step 4	The moved households, with the logins before and after, the assignment ID and the interview keys, to reassign in Headquarters; whether the latest export already shows each move done, and whether a tablet holds the work
`{program}_R{nn}_suso_review.csv`	The tool, step 5	The interviews behind merge questions, by their key, to open under Interviews

Part A · Enumerator

Opening an assignment, calling, logging, saving and exporting

A1 Open your assignment

Your team leader gives you an assignment file, named like `E07_assignment_R05.json` (your enumerator ID and the round). It lists your households for the round, with their phone numbers, their history and the plan for each one's first dial.

1. Open `rtm_interview_tool.html`. The **Enumerator** view opens.
2. Click **Open my assignment file** and choose your file.
3. If the file is protected, the tool asks for its passphrase. Type the passphrase your leader gave you and click **Open**. The passphrase is used only on your computer and is not stored.

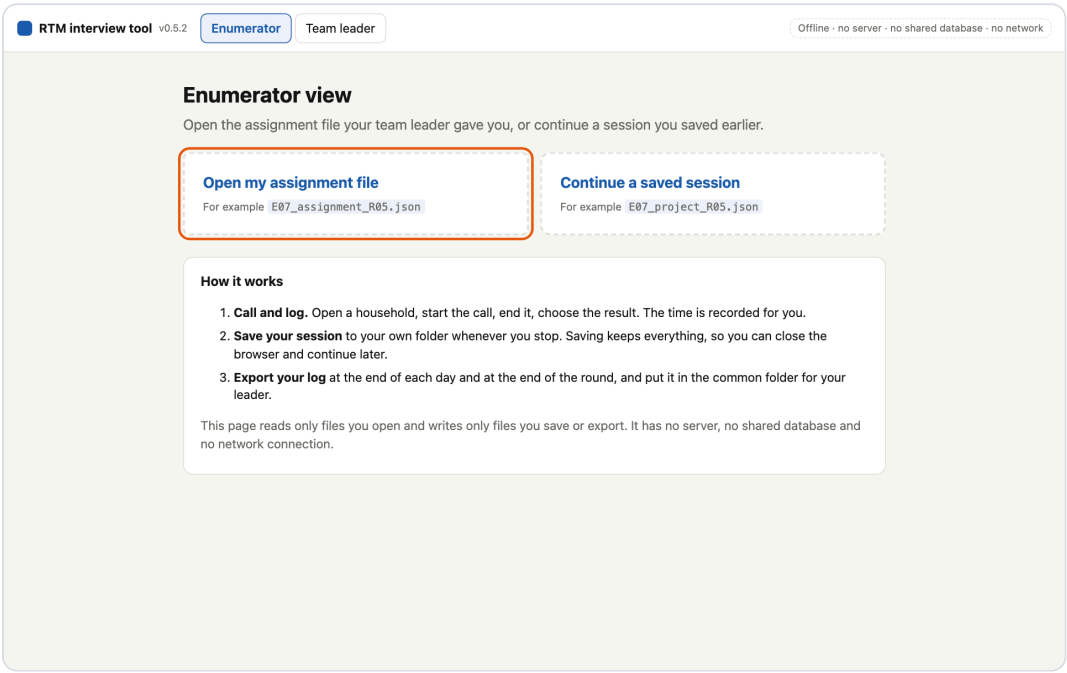


Figure A1. The start page. Open your assignment file the first time; later, continue the session you saved.

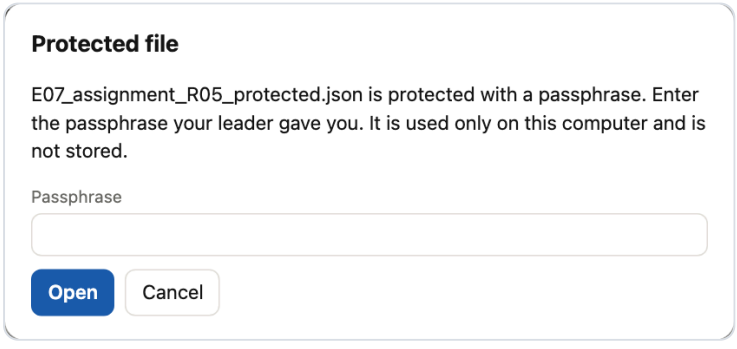


Figure A2. A protected assignment file asks for its passphrase.

To carry on where you stopped, use **Continue a saved session** instead (A18).

A2 The screen at a glance

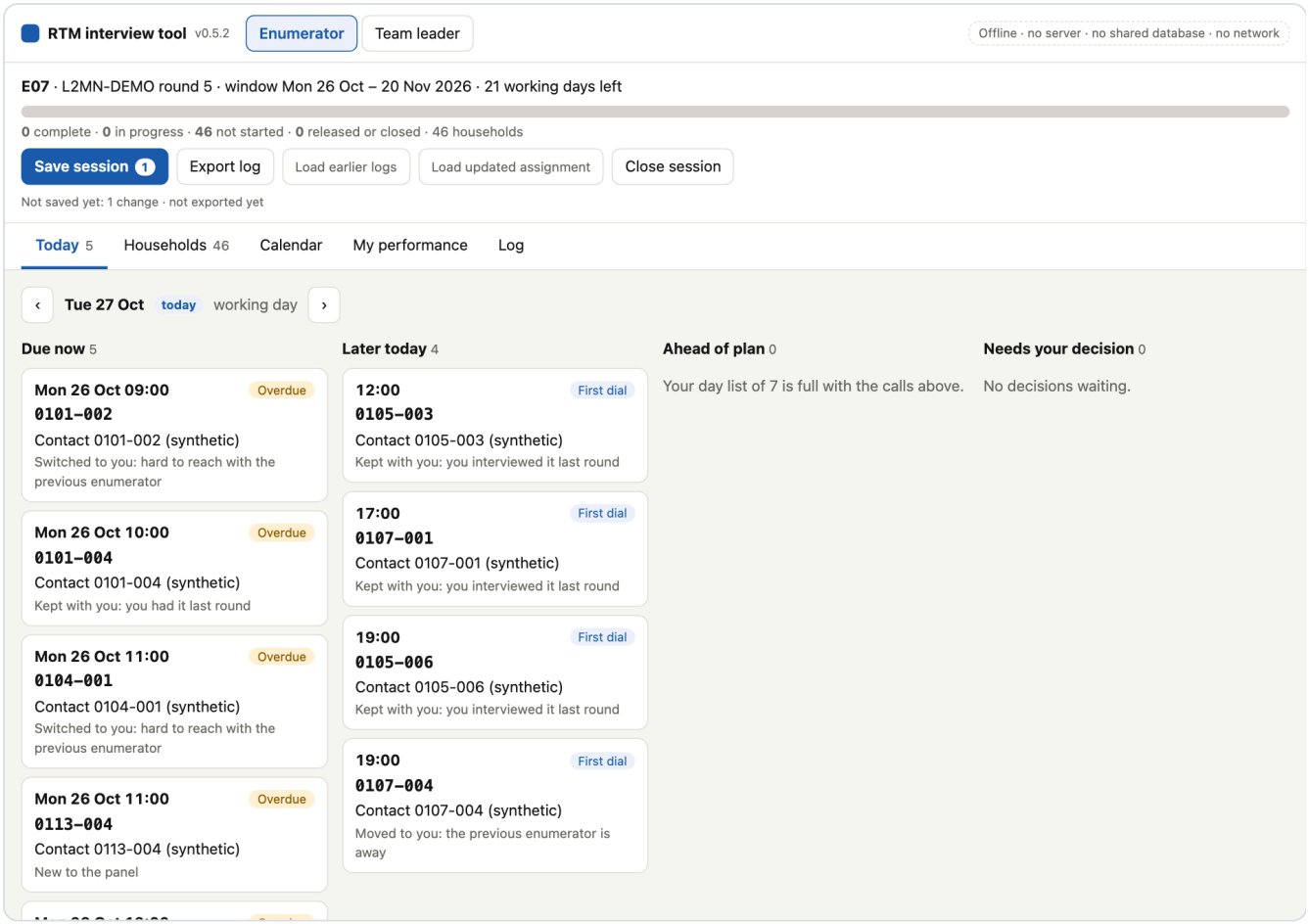


Figure A3. The enumerator's screen after opening an assignment: the summary at the top, the tabs, and today's calls.

The summary at the top gives your enumerator ID, the program and round, the round's window and the working days left. The bar shows the share of your households completed. Under it are the main buttons:

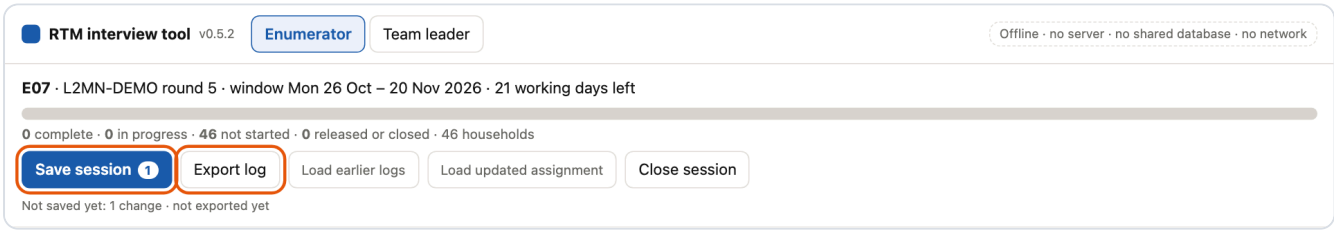


Figure A4. The summary and the main buttons. The number on **Save session** counts the changes not yet saved.

Button	What it does	See
Save session	Saves everything you logged into one file in your own folder, so you can close the browser and continue later	A18
Export log	Writes your call log as a CSV and a JSON file for the common folder	A19
Load earlier logs	Adds your exports from earlier rounds, to compare your performance	A16
Load updated assignment	Opens a new version of your assignment for the same round, keeping what you logged	A20

Close session	Closes the round on this screen; with unsaved changes it offers to save first	A18

The line under the buttons says when you last saved and exported. The tabs below lead to **Today**, **Households**, **Calendar**, **My performance** and **Log**.

A3 The Today tab

The Today tab lists the calls to make, in four columns:

- **Due now:** calls whose time has come, including overdue ones from earlier days.
- **Later today:** calls planned for later in the day, in time order.
- **Ahead of plan:** when fewer households are due or planned today than your leader's **day list** holds (the number is given under the columns), households planned for later days, soonest first, so that unanswered calls do not leave you waiting. Work through them once the calls due are done; a booked callback is never pulled forward.
- **Needs your decision:** households where the next step is not a call, such as a hard refusal to release or a household with no working number.

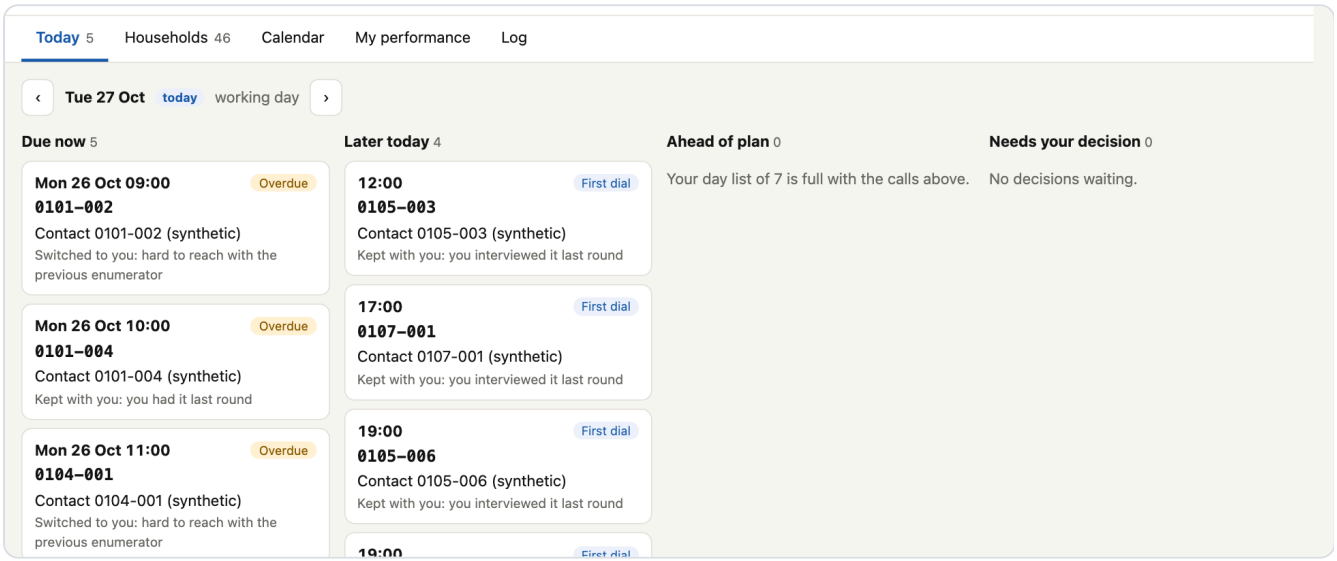


Figure A5. The tabs and the first two columns. Each card shows the planned time, the household ID and contact, and why it is with you or what happened last.

A label on each card says what kind of call it is: **First dial**, **Redial**, **Callback** (an agreed time) or **Overdue**. Use the arrows beside the date to look at another day. Click a card to open the household.

A4 A household's panel

Clicking a household opens its panel on the right. From the top:

- **State and reason:** not started, in progress, complete, and so on, and why the household is with you (R2). **Why is this household with me?** explains the rule your leader used.
- **Next:** the tool's suggestion for the next call, with its time. It says “overdue since” when the time has passed.
- **Usual time:** the hour of the household's last interview, or the hour your leader planned.

- **Last interview** and **last three rounds:** each round's number with a filled dot if the household was interviewed and an empty dot if not; a dash means the household had not joined the panel yet.
- **In the panel since**, **first dial planned** and the **sampling unit** (PSU and stratum).

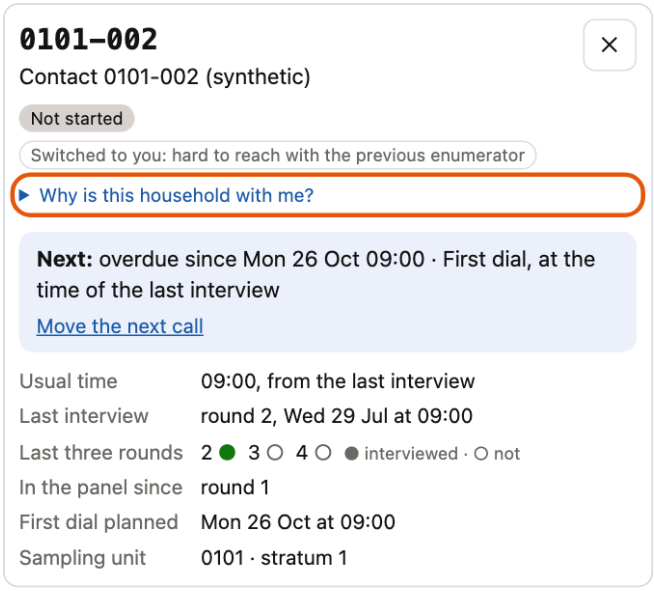


Figure A6. The top of a household's panel.

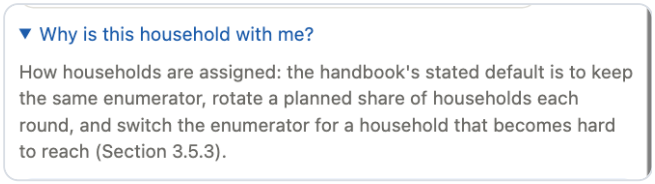


Figure A7. "Why is this household with me?", opened.

A5 Log a call

The tool does not place calls. Dial with your call center's phone system, as you always do, then log the call here.

1. In **Phone numbers**, find the number. **Copy** puts it on the clipboard for your phone system. The line under each number says how its last dial went.
2. After the call, click **Log a call** by that number. The form opens with the number chosen and the start time set to now.
3. Set **Call started** to when you dialled, and **Minutes** to how long the call lasted. If you log several calls at the end of a session, set each one's own start time.

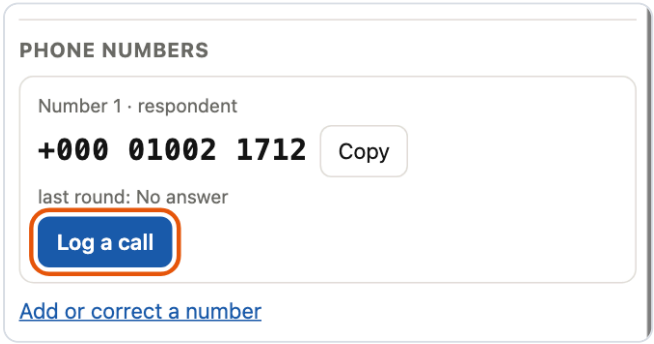


Figure A8. A household's number and the **Log a call** button.

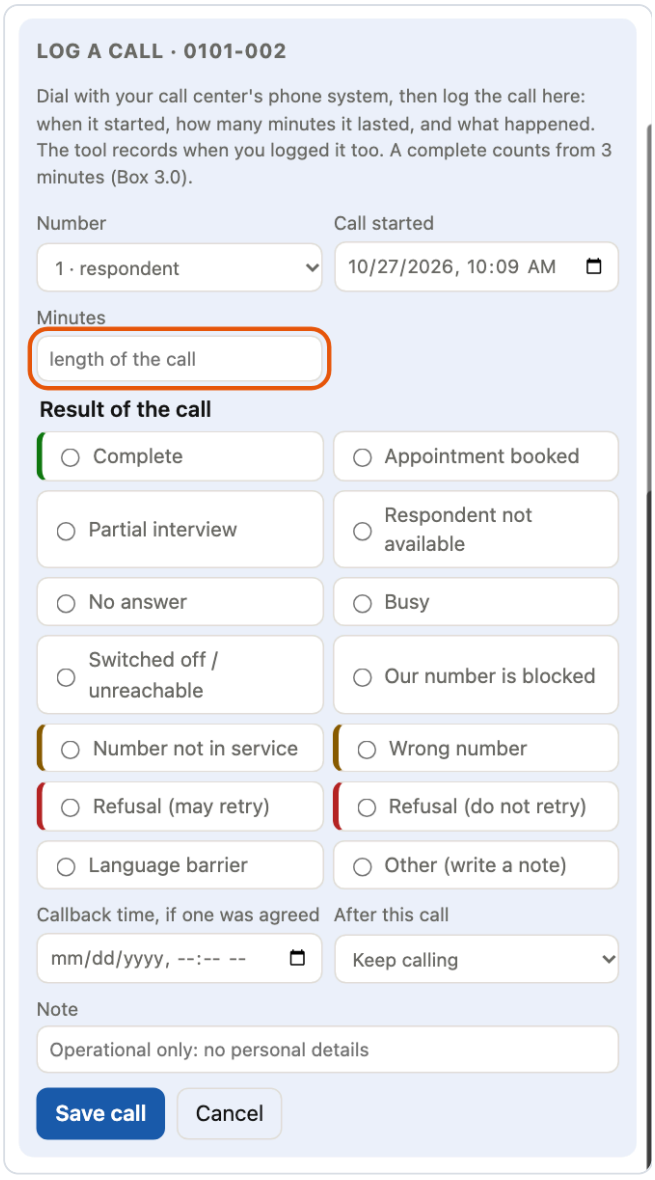


Figure A9. The call log form: the number, when the call started, and its minutes.

> Box 3.0 uses the start and the minutes: a complete needs at least 3 minutes, and dial minutes count toward productivity. Minutes are required for a complete; for other results, enter them when you know them. If your phone system shows the call's length, copy it from there.

A6 The result

In the same form:

1. Choose the **result of the call** (R1 lists them all). The coloured edge marks the kind: green for a complete, brown for a number problem, red for a refusal.
2. If the respondent agreed a time to call back, enter it in **Callback time**. It is required for “Appointment booked”.
3. In **After this call**, keep the default **Keep calling**, or choose **Release for this round** or **Ask for another enumerator next round**.

4. Add a short **note** if useful. Notes are operational only: never write personal details.
5. Click **Save call**. **Cancel** closes the form without logging anything. A start time in the future, or a complete without minutes, is outlined and named before you can save.

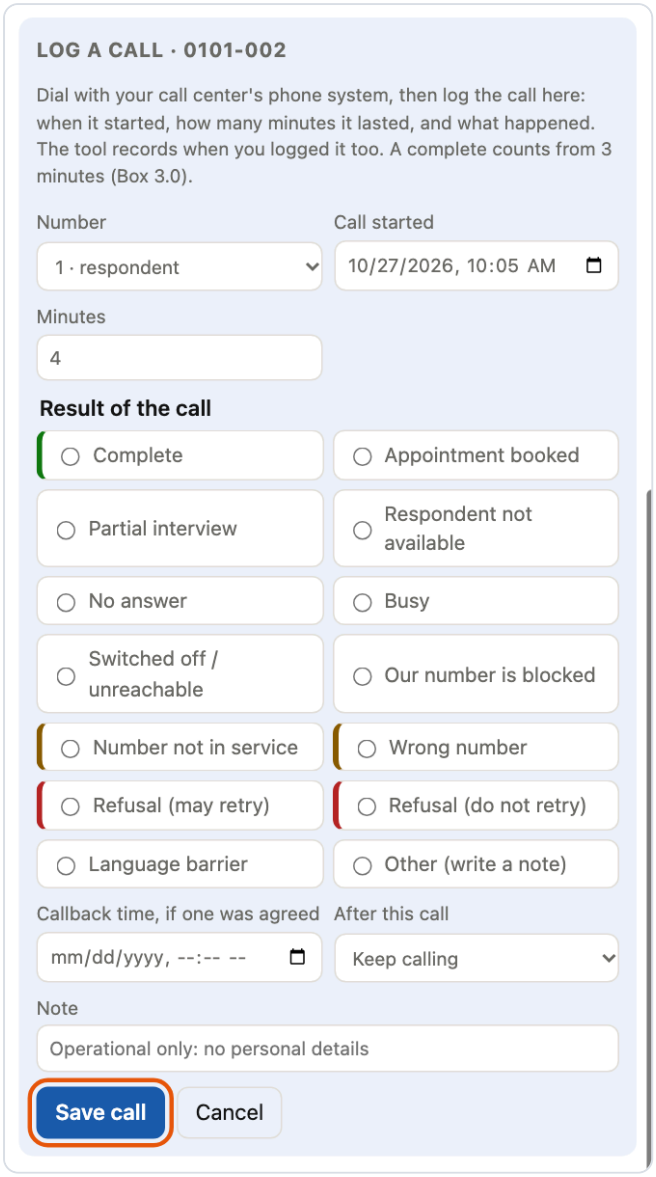


Figure A10. The form filled in: start, minutes and result.

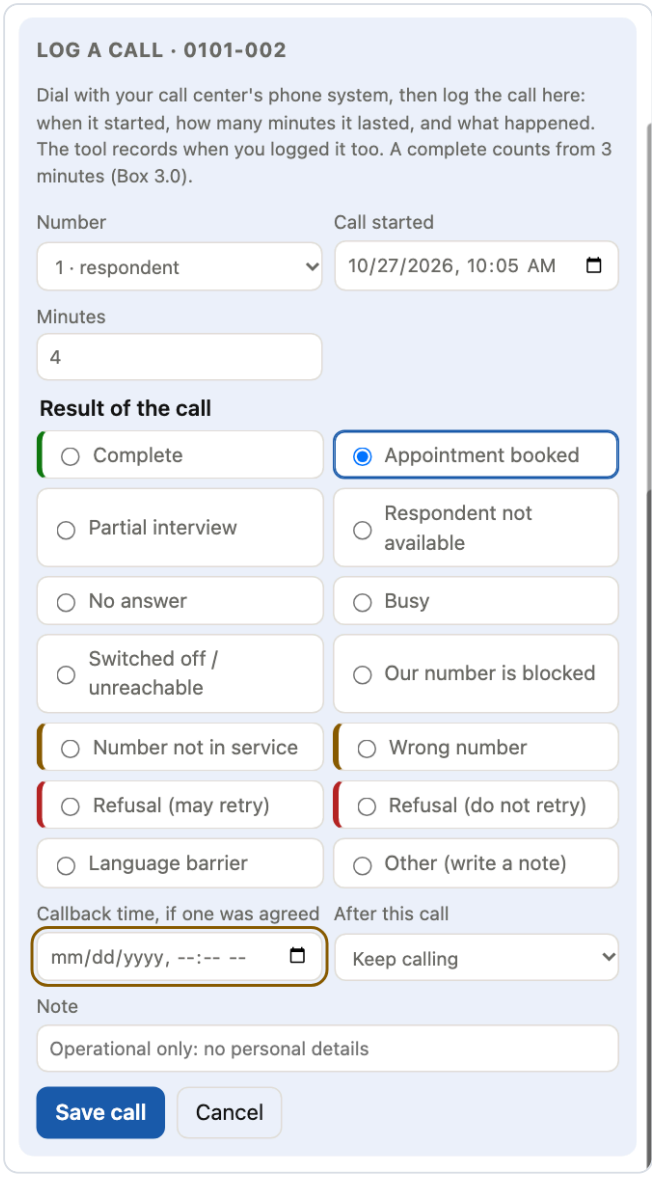


Figure A11. A missing entry is outlined and named in a message: here, the callback time for a booked appointment.

A7 Booked callbacks

A call saved with a callback time moves to that time. It appears in **Later today** (or on its day) with a **Callback** label, ahead of the tool's own suggestions.

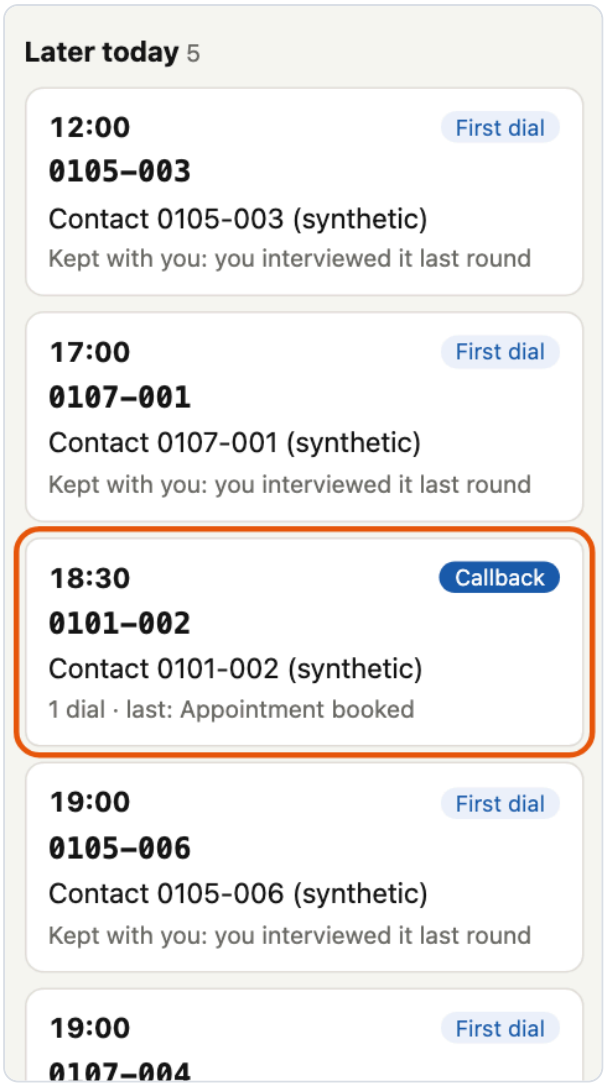


Figure A12. The booked callback at 18:30, in “Later today”.

Without a callback, the tool suggests the next call itself, by your leader's contact protocol: the same day, a set number of hours after the last dial and within the call hours, as long as the day's calls to that household are not used up; otherwise the next working day, at the household's usual hour or, if your leader asks for it, in the part of the day tried least so far (morning, afternoon or evening). Without a protocol the rule is two hours apart with no daily limit. A household never reached after the protocol's days of calls shows **Protocol done** under **Needs your decision**, as at the dial cap: release it, or activate its replacement where the round allows it. A booked callback is never limited by the protocol.

A8 A complete under 3 minutes

Box 3.0 counts a complete only when the interview lasted at least 3 minutes. A shorter one counts as an appointment contact, so the household stays open and the tool tells you why.

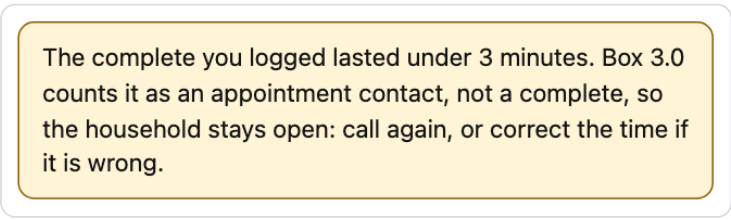


Figure A13. A complete that lasted 2 minutes: call again, or correct the time if it is wrong (A10).

A9 A call logged later

A call you could not log at once, for example one made on another phone, is logged the same way: click **Log a call**, set the start time to when the call was made, and enter its minutes and result. The log keeps both the call's own time and the time you entered it, so your leader can tell a call logged at once from one logged later.

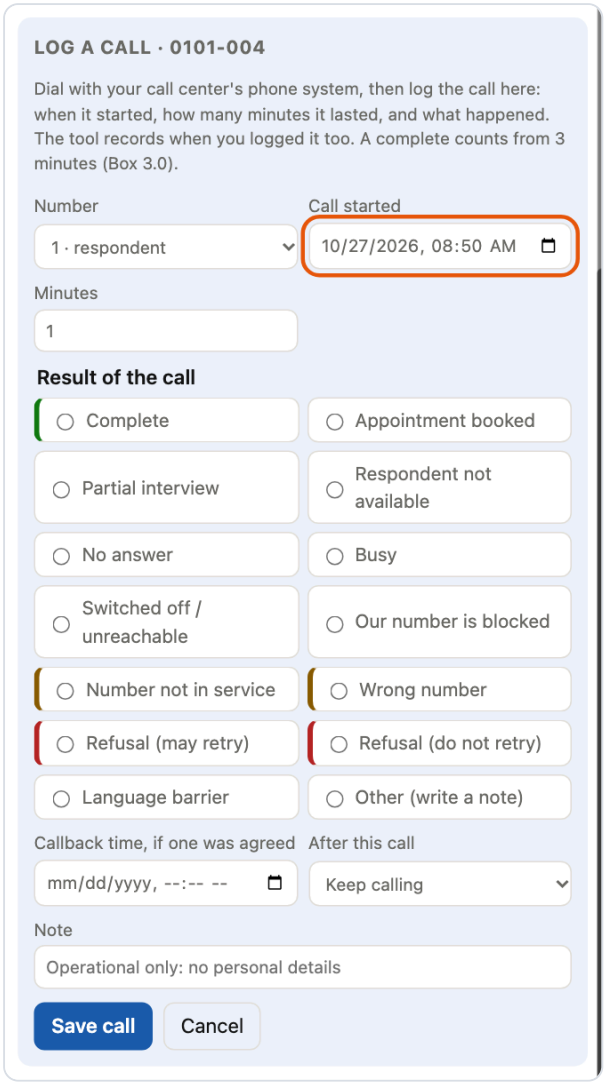


Figure A14. A call logged later: its own start time.

A10 Correct or void an entry

Nothing in the log is ever deleted. To fix a mistake, find the call under **Calls this round** and click **Correct or void**:

- change the result, the number, the start time, the minutes, the callback time or the note; or
- tick **Void this entry** if the call was logged by mistake.

Write **why** you are correcting it (required) and click **Save correction**. The original entry stays in the log, marked as corrected or voided. An action such as a release is undone the same way, with **Undo**.

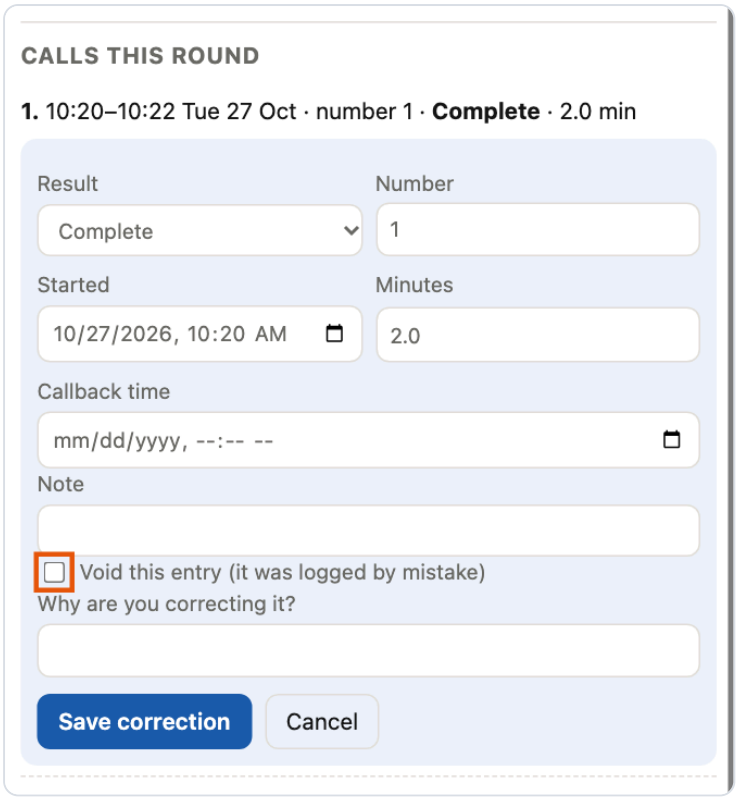


Figure A15. Correcting a logged call. The tick box voids it instead.

A11 Release, switch or removal

The **Actions** at the bottom of a household's panel are case actions, not call results:

- **Release for this round:** stop calling the household this round. It stays in the panel and is called again next round (the handbook's rule is to release, never delete; Section 3.3.5). The reason is optional.
- **Ask for another enumerator:** ask your leader to give the household to someone else next round, for example after a poor contact. Your leader decides.
- **Ask the leader to remove:** only when no number works, or the household has no number at all. Your leader decides.
- **Refer for a field visit:** ask your leader to have the household visited in person, to check its numbers, agree a time to call or reassure it about the survey. You keep calling meanwhile; the visit's outcome comes back as your leader's note on the household in your next updated file.

When a call shows that the respondent has blocked your number, log it with the result **Our number is blocked**. The household then waits under **Needs your decision**, and your leader sees it and can move it to a colleague.

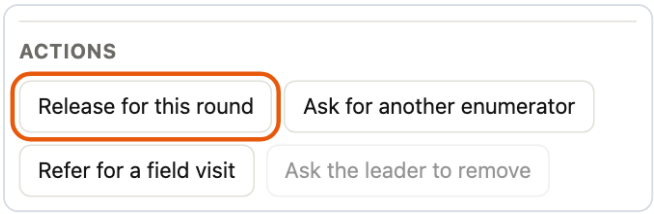


Figure A16. A household's actions.

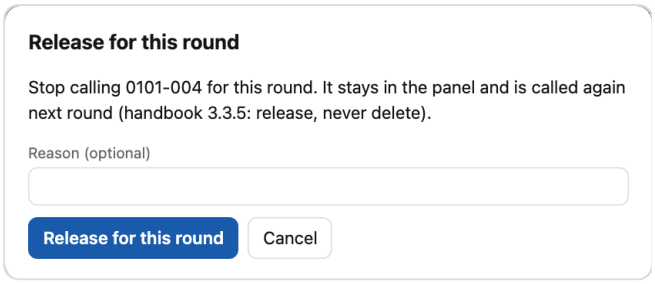


Figure A17. Releasing a household for the round.

A12 Add or correct a number

If a respondent gives a new number, or a number is wrong, click **Add or correct a number**. Choose which number (or a new one) and whether you correct it or mark it as not working, type the number and whose it is, and click **Save number**. The new number can be dialled at once. It goes to your leader in a separate contacts file when you export (A19), never in the log for the common folder.

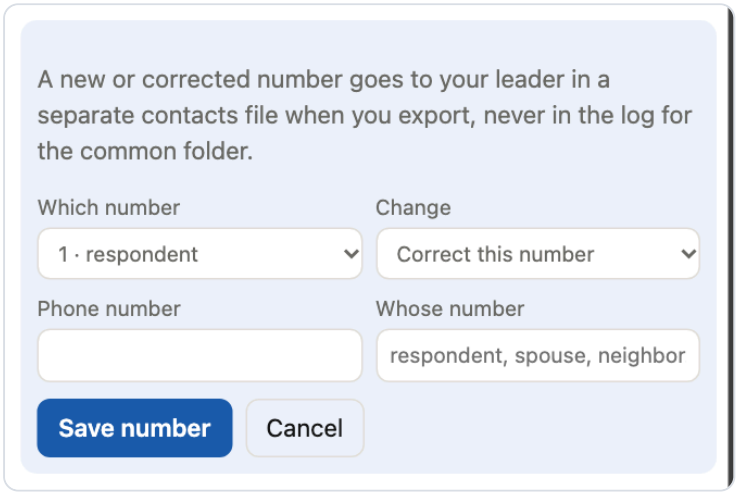


Figure A18. Adding or correcting a phone number.

A13 Replacements

Some households come with replacement households, listed in their panel in the order the sample was drawn. A replacement can be used only when the round's rules allow it, by default after a hard refusal or when no number works. Then:

1. Click **Activate the next replacement**.
2. Write why (required) and confirm. The replacement becomes a household to call, and the original household is closed for the round.

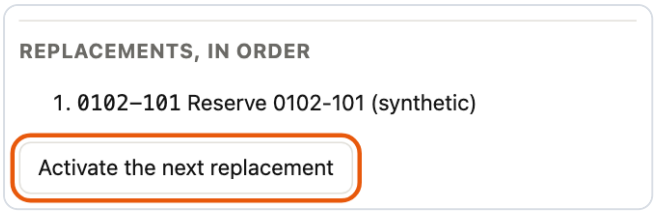


Figure A19. After a hard refusal, the next replacement can be activated.

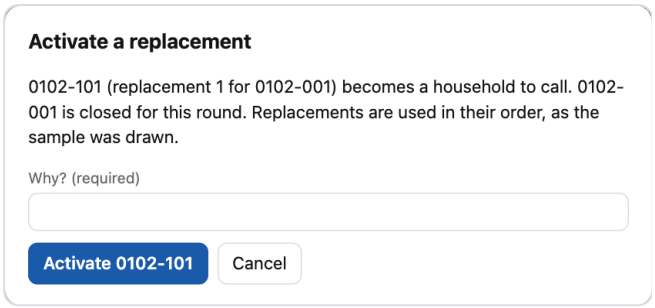


Figure A20. Confirming a replacement, with the reason.

When the button is greyed out, the line beside it says why, for example that replacements are allowed only after a hard refusal or when no number works.

When your leader approves each replacement. Some rounds keep replacements with the leader. The button then reads **Ask the leader for a replacement**. Write why and confirm: the household waits, marked **Replacement asked**, and you stop calling it. Your leader decides in a batch and sends you an updated file (A20). If the leader releases the replacement, it comes into your list with its contacts and the original household is closed as replaced. If the leader declines, the household opens again with the leader's note: keep calling. To call the household again before the leader decides, undo the request under **Actions**.

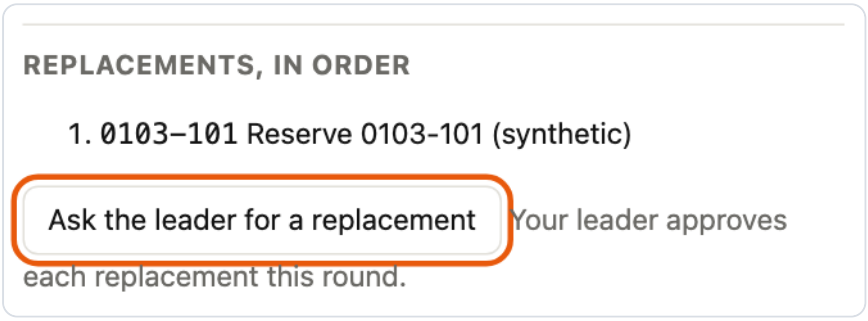


Figure A32. When the leader approves replacements: the button asks instead of activating.

A14 The Households tab

The Households tab lists all your households in a table: their contact, why each is with you, the first dial planned, the number of dials, the last result, the next step and the state. Use the filters above it (open, not started, in progress, complete, released or closed, needs the leader, all) and the search box for an ID or a name. Click a row to open the household.

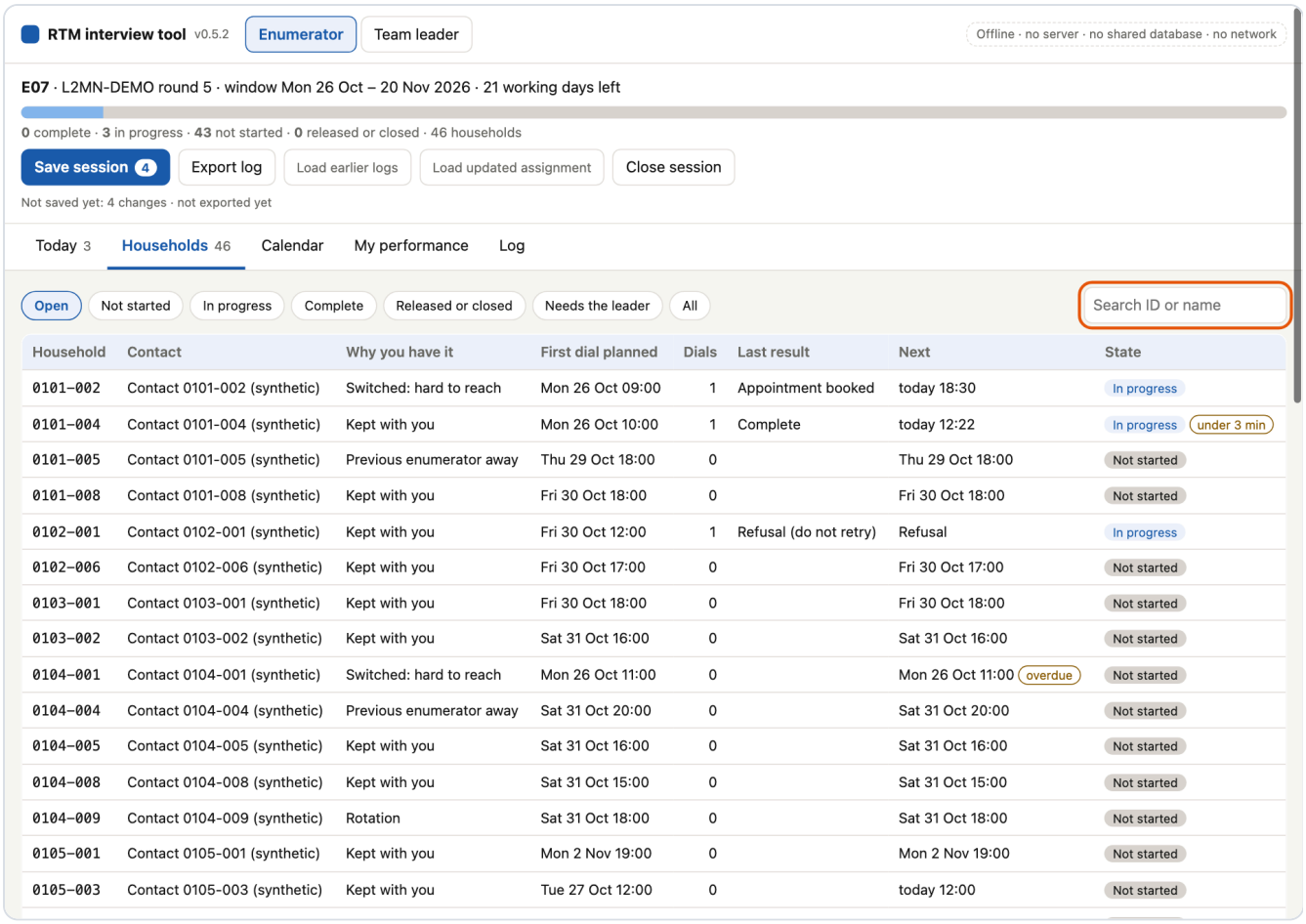


Figure A21. The Households tab, with its filters and the search box.

A15 The Calendar tab

The Calendar shows the round's window month by month. Days inside the window are white; days outside are grey. Hatched days get no calls planned automatically: days the call center does not work, and public holidays. Each day shows the first dials planned, callbacks booked, and the dials made and completes. Click a day to see its calls.

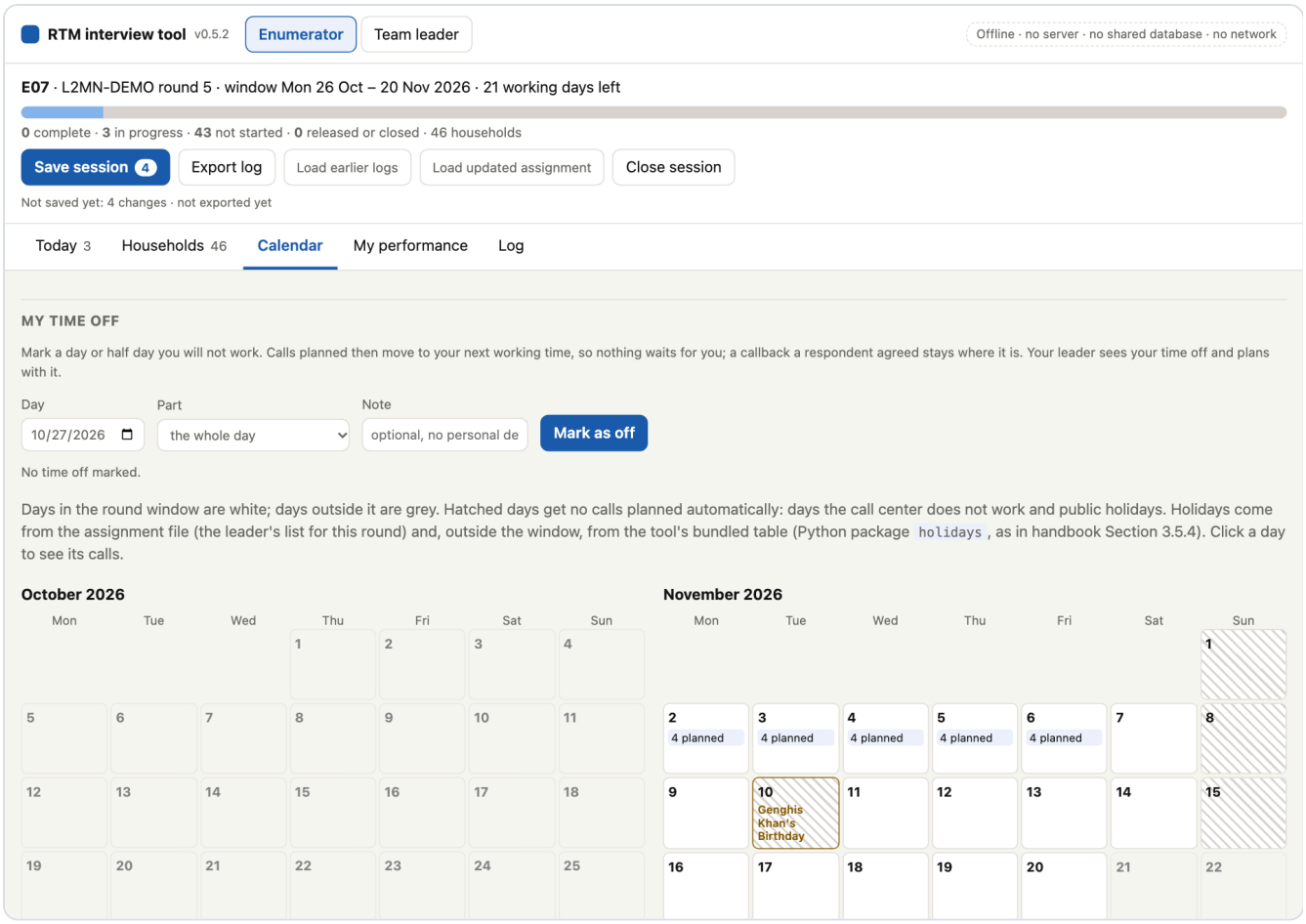


Figure A22. The Calendar tab. 10 November, a public holiday, is hatched.

> Holidays are left out of the automatic plan but never block calling: you can still call and log on a holiday. Your leader can mark a holiday as a working day.

A16 My performance

My performance gives your own figures, with the definitions of Box 3.0: dials, completes, success rate, dials per complete, first-dial success, enumerator-days and completes per enumerator-day. The columns compare this round so far with this month, last month and all the logs loaded. Click **Load earlier logs** and choose your exports from earlier rounds to fill the comparison.

When my calls succeed shows, by hour, the share of your dials on which the interview took place. Hours with fewer than 10 dials are hatched: too few to judge. **The plan ahead** counts the first dials, redials and callbacks for the coming days.

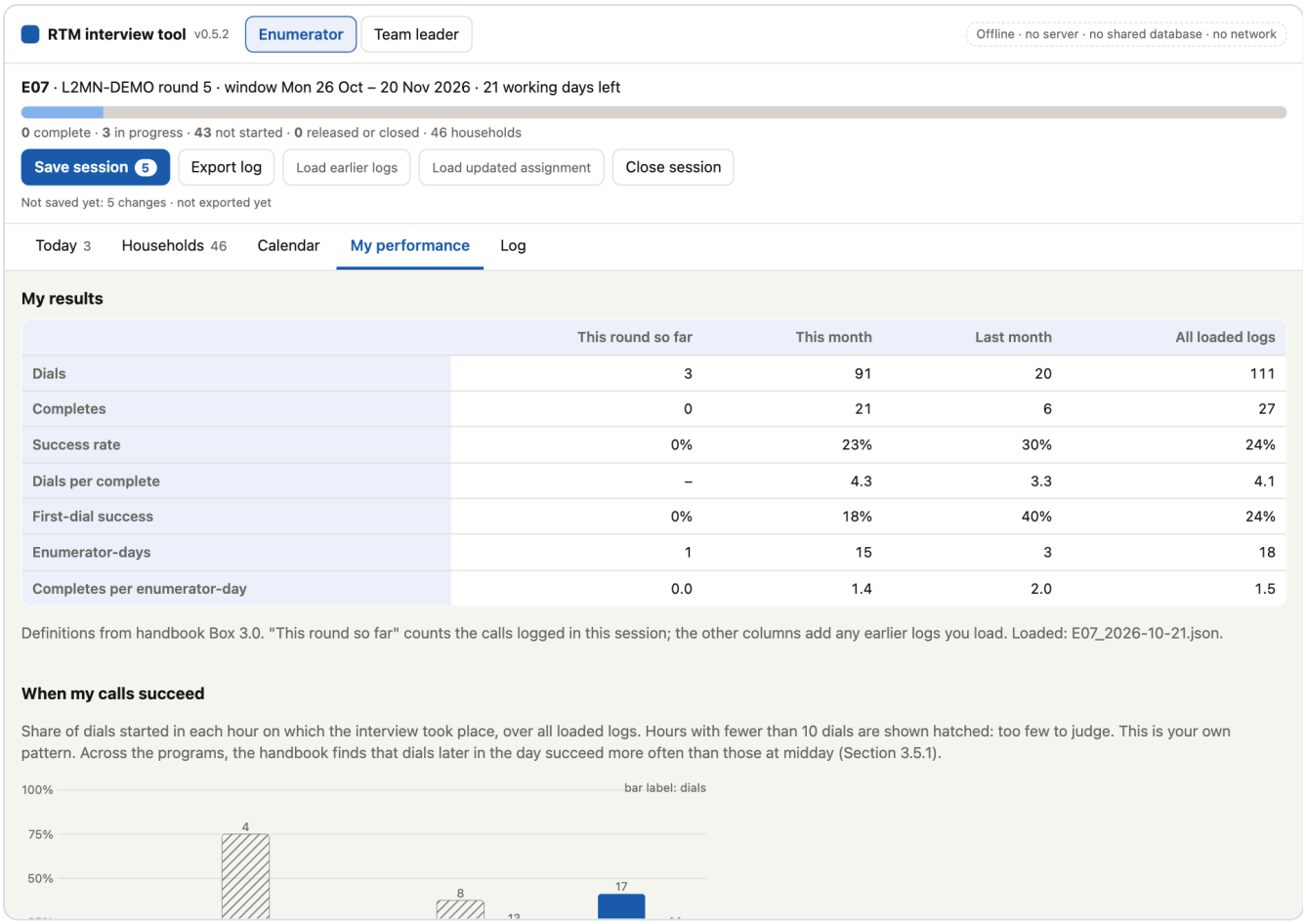


Figure A23. My performance, with an earlier round's log loaded.

A17 The Log tab

The Log lists every entry in your session: each call, action, correction and number change, who logged it and when. Its integrity check confirms that no entry was changed after it was logged. You cannot edit the log here; corrections are new entries (A10).

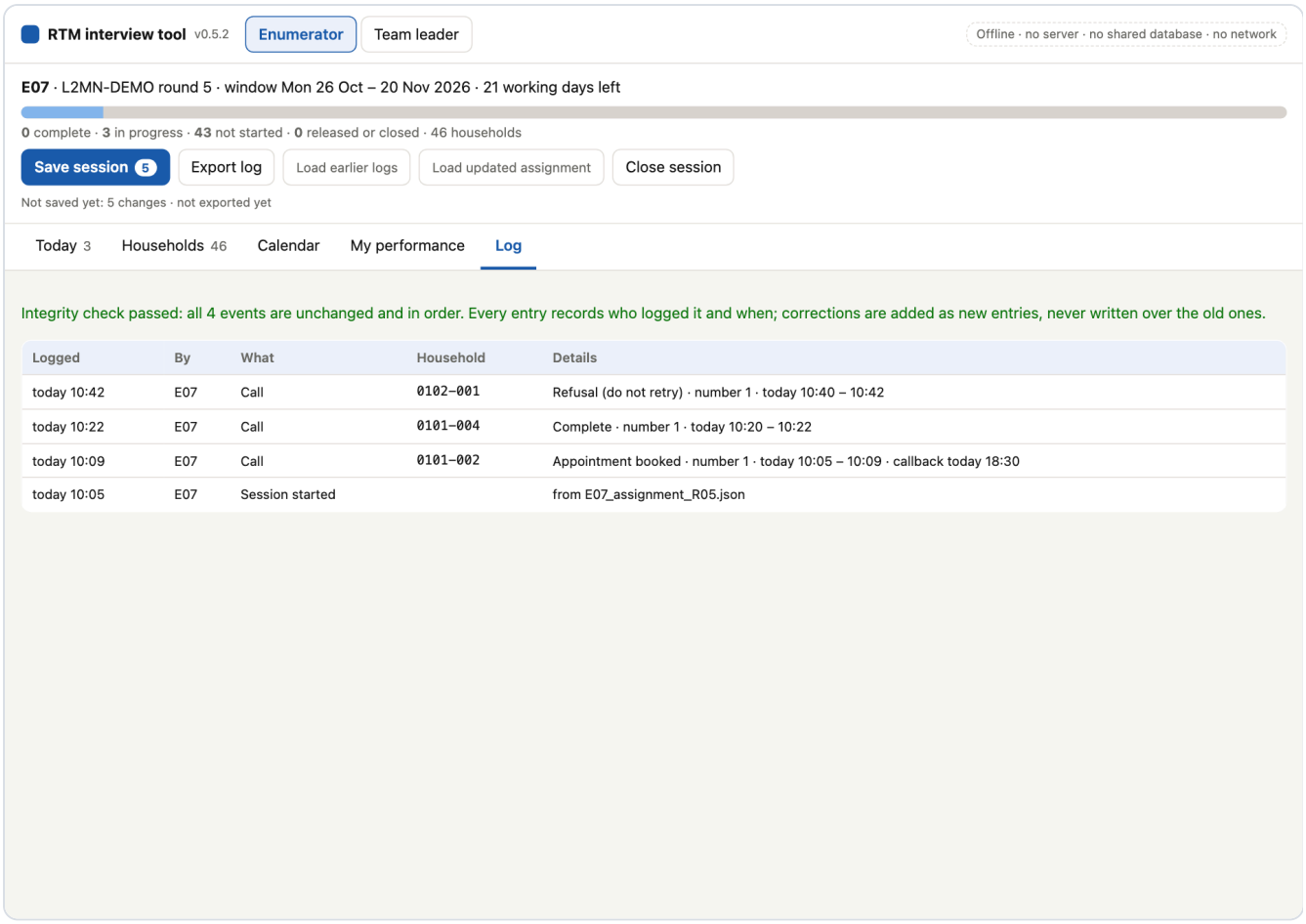


Figure A24. The Log tab and its integrity check.

A18 Save, close and continue

Save your session whenever you stop, and at least every few calls. Click **Save session**:

- In Chrome, the first save asks where to put the file, named like `E07_project_R05.json`, in your own folder; later saves overwrite it.
- In other browsers, each save downloads a new file with the time in its name.

Keep saved sessions in your own folder, not the common one. If your session file is protected, it is protected with your assignment's passphrase. After ten unsaved changes, a reminder appears.

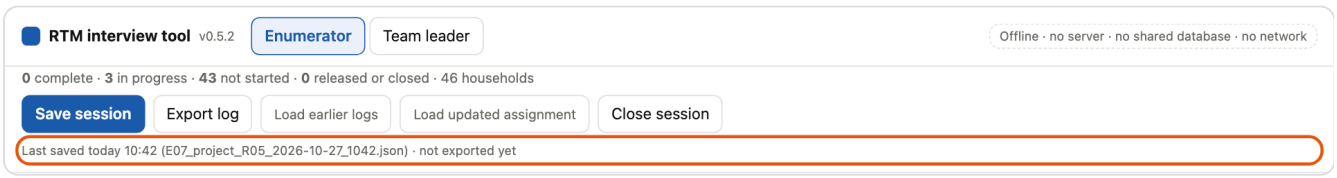


Figure A25. After saving, the line under the buttons gives the time and the file.

Close session asks first when changes are not saved: **Save, then close** (the main choice), **Close without saving**, or **Cancel**. The browser also warns you before you close the page with unsaved changes.

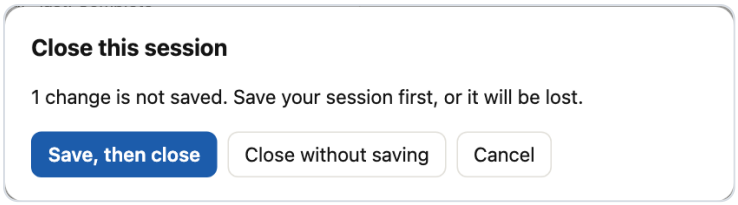


Figure A26. Closing with an unsaved change.

To continue later, open the tool, click **Continue a saved session** on the start page (Figure A1) and choose your saved session file. Everything comes back, and the tool checks that the file was not changed.

A19 Export your log

At the end of each day, and at the end of the round, click **Export log**:

1. Download both files, named like `E07_2026-10-27.csv` and `E07_2026-10-27.json`.
2. Put both in the common folder. They hold household IDs, times and results, but no names or phone numbers.
3. If you added or corrected a number, a third file, `E07_2026-10-27_contacts.json`, is offered. Give it to your leader directly, never in the common folder.

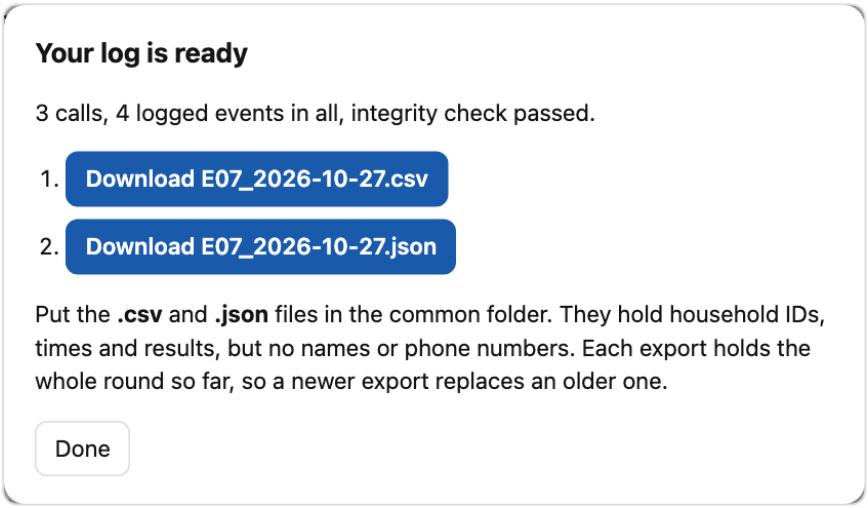


Figure A27. The export window.

> Each export holds the whole round so far, so a newer export replaces an older one. Exporting does not replace saving: save your session as well.

A20 An updated assignment

Your leader may send a new version of your assignment during the round, for example after moving households between enumerators so that the round finishes on time. Click **Load updated assignment** and choose the new file. The tool keeps every call you logged, adds the new households, and marks those no longer yours as “No longer yours”: their calls stay in your log, but you cannot log new ones for them. A file for another enumerator or another round is refused, and so is a file older than the one in your session.

A household moved to you shows who had it before and the calls they made, with the reason “Moved to you mid-round”. Those calls count toward the dial cap: if the previous enumerator made 7 of 8, you have

one left. Its first dial is planned for the day of the move, at the household's usual hour; if the household had booked a callback with the previous enumerator, that callback is yours now and the household is due at that time. Households you already had keep their plan and history even when the new file does not repeat them. If you join a round that has started, your first file is such an updated assignment: open it with **Open assignment** as usual.

A21 On a phone

The page also works on a phone's browser. The columns stack, and a household's panel fills the screen; close it with the ✕ to return to the list.

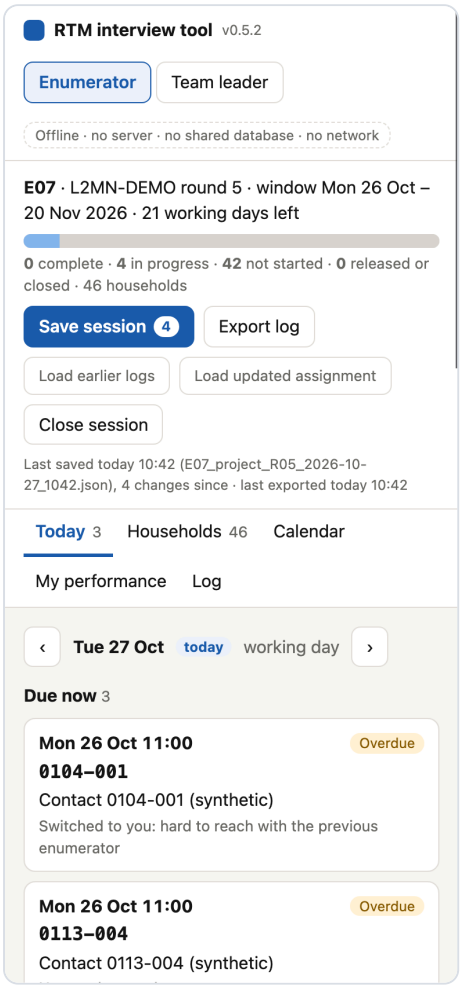


Figure A28. Today, on a phone.

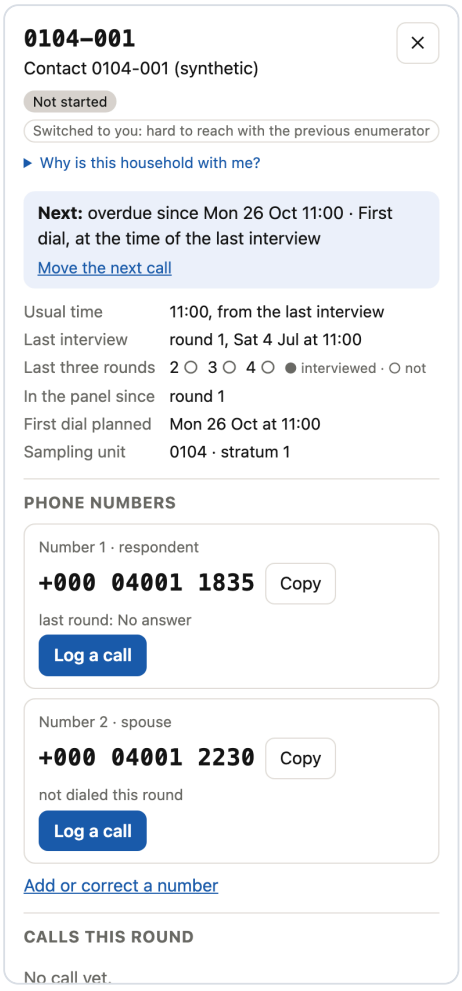


Figure A29. A household, on a phone.

A22 Good practice and messages

- Log each call as soon as it ends, with its start and minutes: the times are part of the data.
- Save whenever you stop; export at the end of each day.
- Never write personal details in notes. Keep your assignment and saved sessions in your own folder.
- Use a release, not a refusal code, to stop calling a household for the round.

Message	What to do

“Choose the result of the call.” or another missing entry	Fill in the outlined field, then save again
“This complete lasted under 3 minutes…”	Call again, or correct the time if it is wrong (A8, A10)
“N changes are not saved yet.”	Click Save session
A file is protected	Type the passphrase from your leader; it is not stored
“… is a saved session, not an assignment.”	Use Continue a saved session instead
A file for another enumerator or round is refused	Check with your leader that you have your own file
“First calls are made by …”	Choose a day up to that date, or ask your leader (A23)
“Your leader has not allowed …”	Tell your leader directly; the setting is theirs (A23, A24)

A23 Move a household's next call

The plan cannot know everything you learn on the phone. When you know a better time to call a household, move its next call yourself, if your leader allows it this round.

1. Open the household. Under **Next**, click **Move the next call**.
2. Choose the day and time, and say why: someone told you when to call, the household answers at another time, your day is too full, or another reason with a note.
3. Click **Save the new time**. The household's next call now says **Moved by you**, and appears in your Today tab at that time. **Undo my change** returns it to the plan.

The new time must be inside the round window, on a working day and inside the call hours. A household not yet called must get its first call by the date your leader set, so that first calls stay early in the round (Section 3.4), unless your leader allows more. Your next dial on the household ends the change: the tool then plans the following call as usual. A callback the respondent agreed cannot be moved this way, since the respondent chose it: correct the callback time on that call (A10). Every change is in your log with its reason, and your leader sees it.

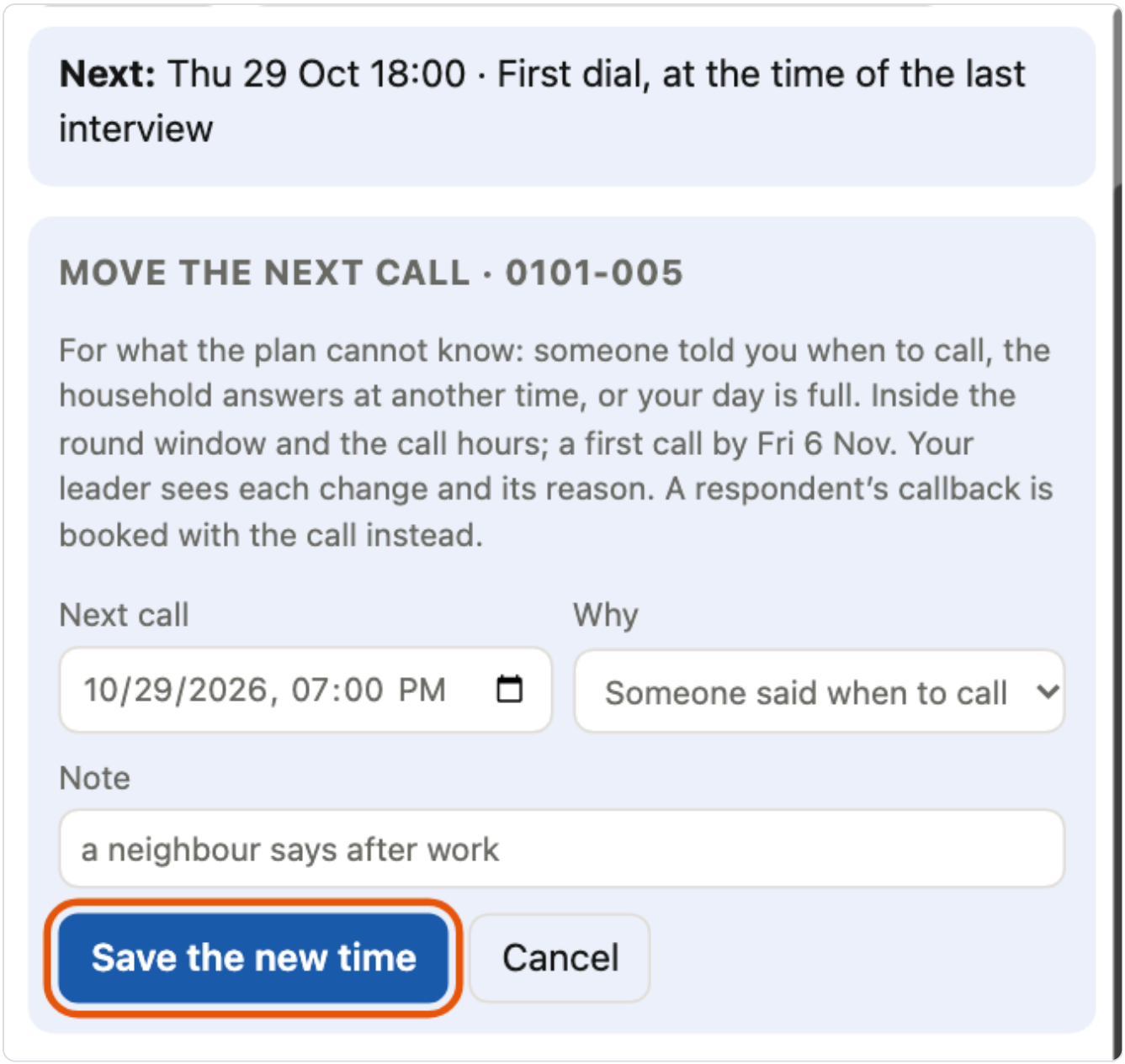


Figure A30. Moving a household's next call, with the reason.

A24 Mark time off

When you will not work a day or half a day, tell the tool, if your leader allows it this round. On the **Calendar** tab, under **My time off**, choose the day and the whole day, the morning (until 13:00) or the afternoon (from 13:00), and click **Mark as off**. The day is marked on the calendar.

- The calls planned for that time move to your next working time, so nothing waits for you.
- A callback a respondent agreed for that time does not move. The tool names those households before you confirm: call them earlier, rebook them with the respondent, or ask your leader to give them to a colleague.
- **I will work after all** takes the time off back.
- Your leader sees your time off when your export arrives, and the round's pace counts only the days you work.

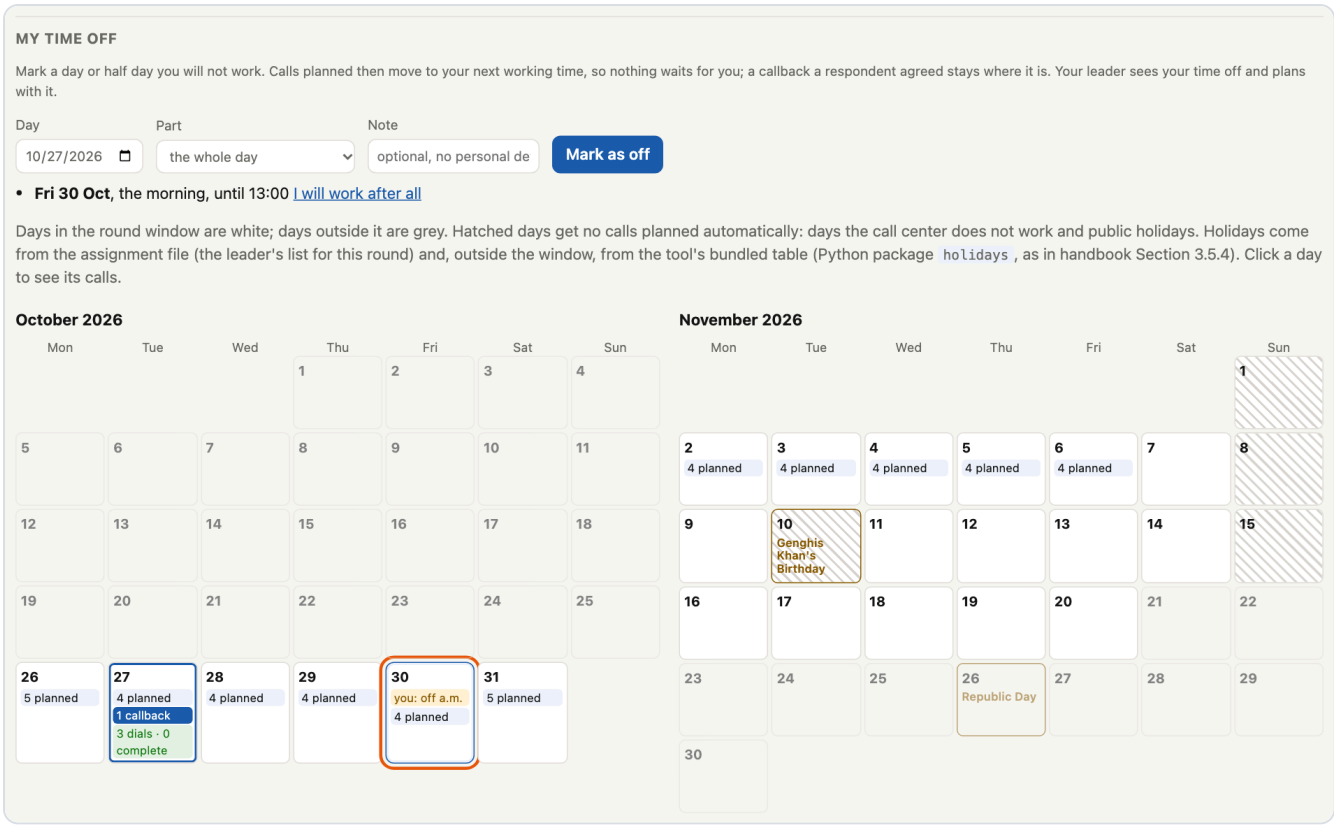


Figure A31. My time off on the Calendar tab, with a morning marked.

Part B · Team leader

Preparing a round, giving out files, importing exports, following progress

B1 Start or continue a session

Click **Team leader** at the top of the page. To prepare a new round, fill in **Start a round**:

1. your leader ID, for example `L01`, and the program code, for example `L2MN`;
2. the country, which picks the holiday calendar;
3. the round number. Click **Start**.

To carry on, click **Continue a saved leader session** and choose your session file (B11). If you only want to import logs for a round you prepared earlier, start the round the same way and open its manifest on the Import tab (B12).

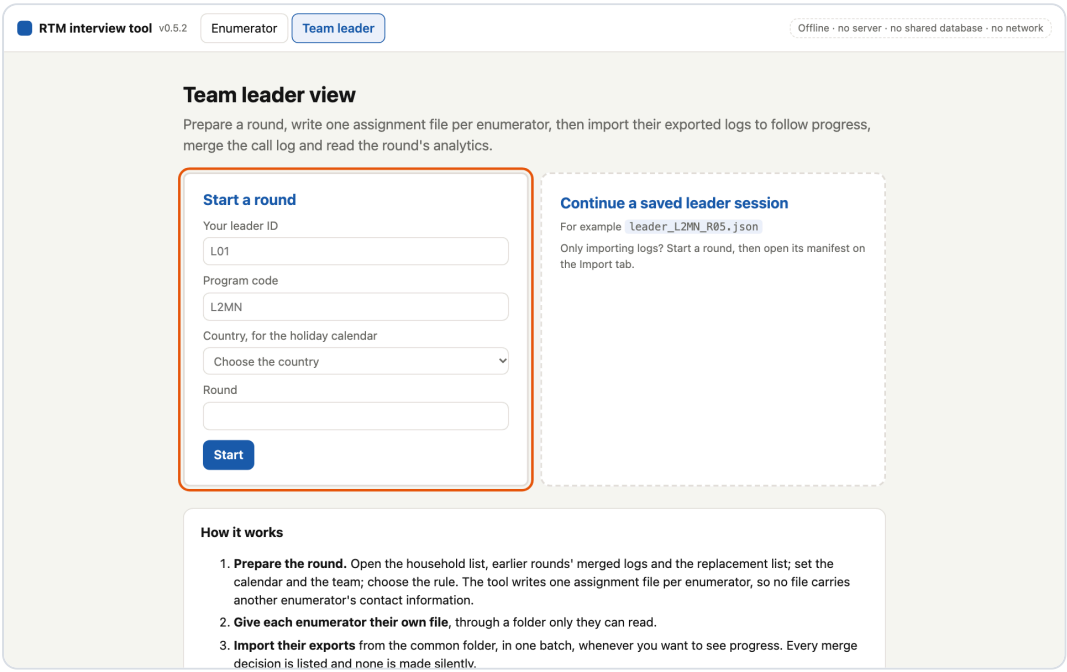


Figure B1. The leader's start page.

B2 The Prepare tab

The session opens on **Prepare round**, eight numbered steps from top to bottom. The other tabs are **Import logs**, **Progress**, **Call log**, **Analytics** and **Risk lists**. The number on **Save leader session** counts the changes not yet saved.

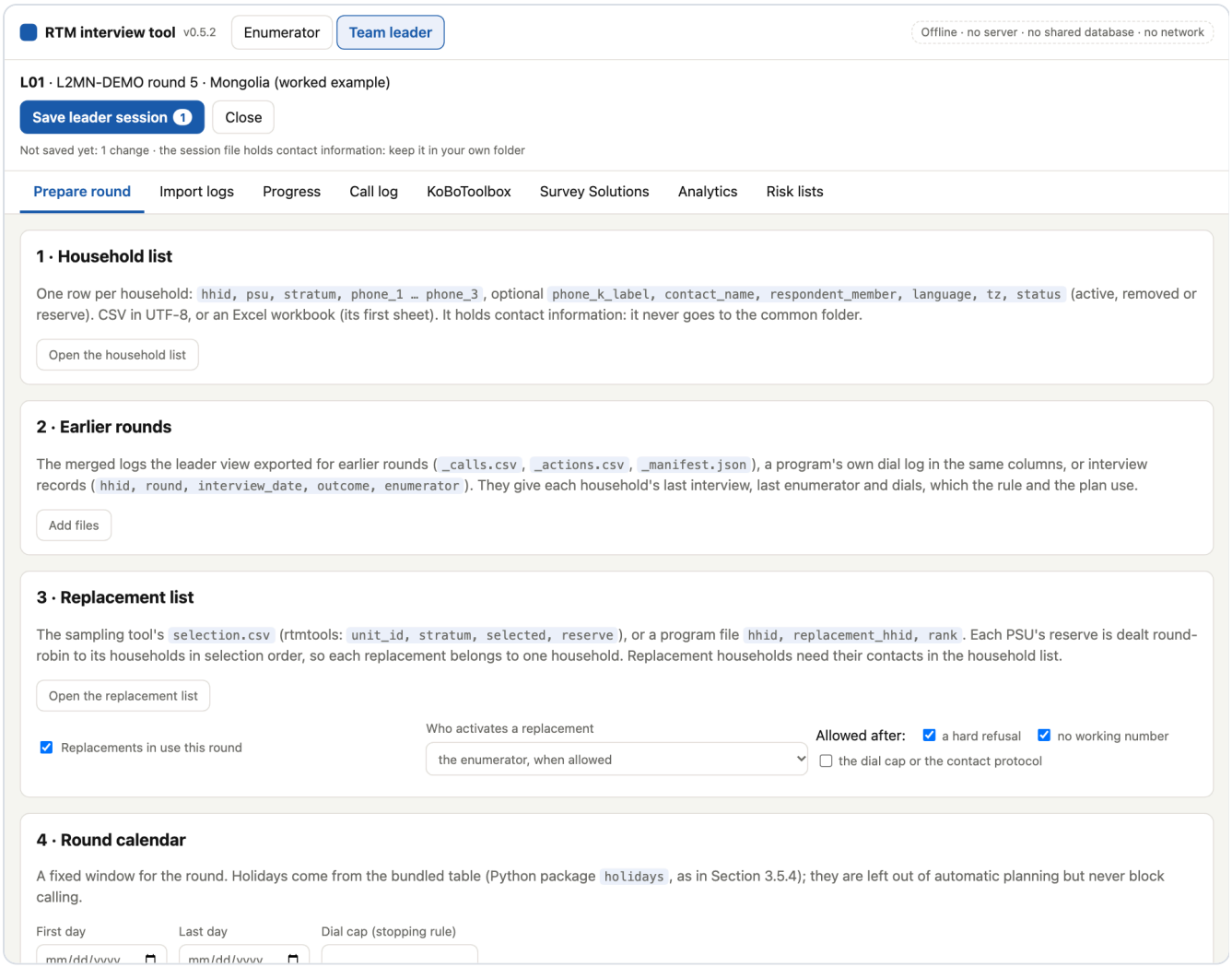


Figure B2. The Prepare tab before any file is opened.

B3 Step 1 · Household list

Click **Open the household list** and choose the program's list: a CSV file in UTF-8, or an Excel workbook (its first sheet). One row per household, with these columns:

Column	Content
`hhid` , `psu` , `stratum`	The household's ID, its sampling unit and stratum
`phone_1` … `phone_3`	Up to three numbers; `phone_k_label` says whose each is
`contact_name` , `respondent_member` , `language` , `tz`	Optional
`status`	`active` (the default), `removed` (kept in the list, never deleted) or `reserve` (a replacement not yet used)

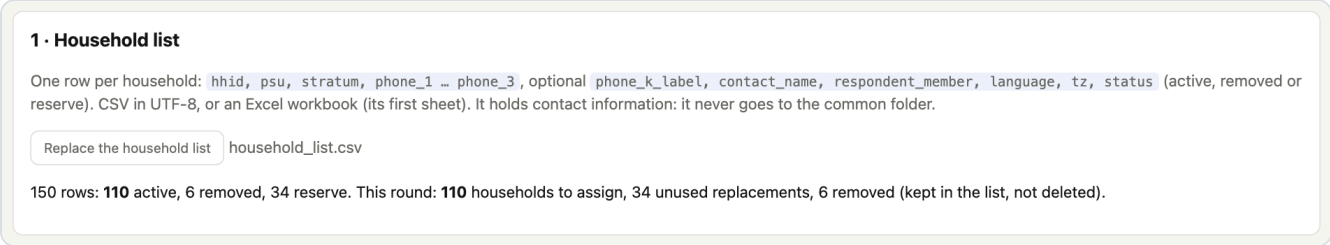


Figure B3. The household list, read: 110 households to assign this round.

> The household list holds contact information. Keep it in your own folder; it never goes in the common folder.

B4 Step 2 · Earlier rounds

Click **Add files** and choose the files of earlier rounds, all at once:

- the merged files this tool wrote for earlier rounds (`_calls.csv` , `_actions.csv` and `_manifest.json`); or
- a program's own dial log in the same columns; or
- interview records with `hhid, round, interview_date, outcome, enumerator` .

They give each household's last interview, last enumerator and dials, which the rule and the plan use. The table shows, for each round, the households, dials and interviewed households. If a program's own result codes are not the tool's, the tool asks you to map each one once.

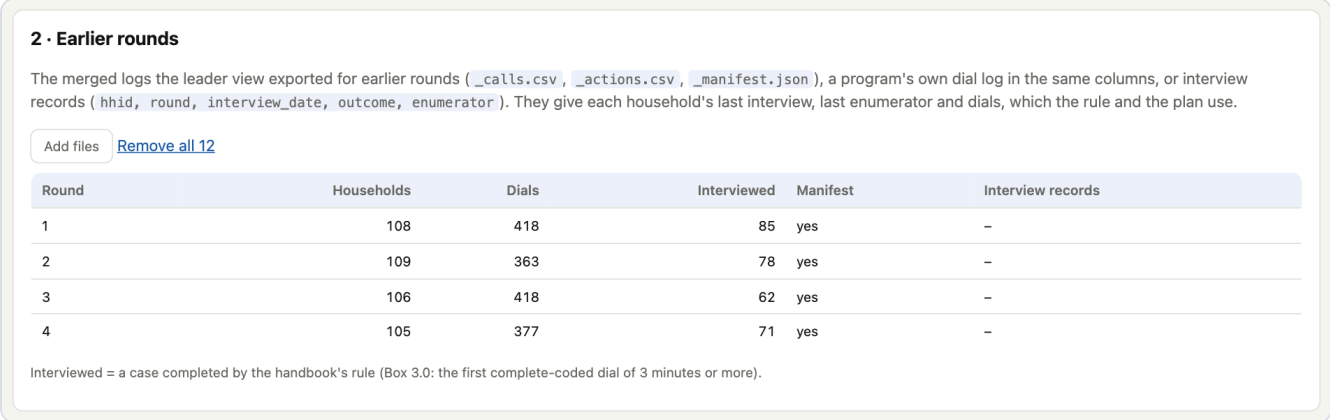


Figure B4. Four earlier rounds, read. Interviewed means a case completed by Box 3.0's rule.

B5 Step 3 · Replacement list

Click **Open the replacement list** and choose either the sampling tool's `selection.csv` (rtmtools: `unit_id, stratum, selected, reserve`) or a program file with `hhid, replacement_hhid, rank` . Each PSU's reserve is dealt in turn to its households in selection order, so each replacement belongs to one household. Replacement households need their contacts in the household list.

Under the summary, tick **Replacements in use this round** and choose when they are **allowed**: after a hard refusal, when no number works, or when the dial cap or the contact protocol is reached. Choose also **who activates a replacement**: the enumerator, when one of those cases is met (the default), or **the leader approves each request**. With the leader's approval, an enumerator asks instead of activating, the

household waits, and you release or decline the requests in batches on the Progress tab (B15), which writes the revised files.



Figure B5. An rtmtools selection, read: one replacement for each of 36 households.

B6 Step 4 · Round calendar

1. Set the round's **first day** and **last day** (a fixed window) and the **dial cap**, the program's stopping rule in dials. The team, dial cap and call hours are taken from the last round's manifest when one is loaded.
2. Tick the **working days** and set the **call hours** and the **time zone**.
3. Choose over what share of the working days the first dials are spread (50% by default), to front-load the contact effort (Section 3.4).
4. Set the **day list**: how many households each enumerator's Today tab offers at most each day. It is taken from the last round's manifest when one is loaded; empty, it becomes 1.5 × the busiest enumerator's planned first dials per day, shown once the rule is applied (step 6). The enumerator sees the calls due first, then households pulled forward from later days (“Ahead of plan”, A3), so that unanswered calls leave nobody waiting.
5. Check the **holidays inside the window**. They come from a table bundled with the tool, built from the Python package `holidays`. Tick **Call center works** for a holiday you will work, **remove** a day that is not a holiday, or **add a day off**, such as a regional or decreed closure. Dates the table estimates, such as lunar holidays, are labelled; correct them when the official dates are known.
6. Set the **contact protocol**: at most how many calls a day to one household, at least how many hours apart, and over at most how many working days for a household never reached; and whether each new day of calls starts in the part of the day tried least so far (morning until 12:00, afternoon until 17:00, evening). Three calls a day over five working days, at different times of day, is 15 calls: the step shows that sum against the dial cap. A household never reached by the last of its days is done, as at the dial cap; tick **the dial cap or the contact protocol** in step 3 if a replacement may follow. Empty fields keep the earlier rule: two hours apart, no daily or day limit. The protocol travels in the assignment files, and last round's carries over.
7. Decide **what enumerators may change themselves**: move a household's next call with a reason (A23), and mark a day or half day off (A24). Both are on by default. A first call stays inside the plan's first-call period, the days over which first dials are spread, unless you also tick **also a first call past the first-call period**. A respondent's callback never moves this way. The setting travels in the assignment files: a change sets the written files aside, and the assignment stays as it is.

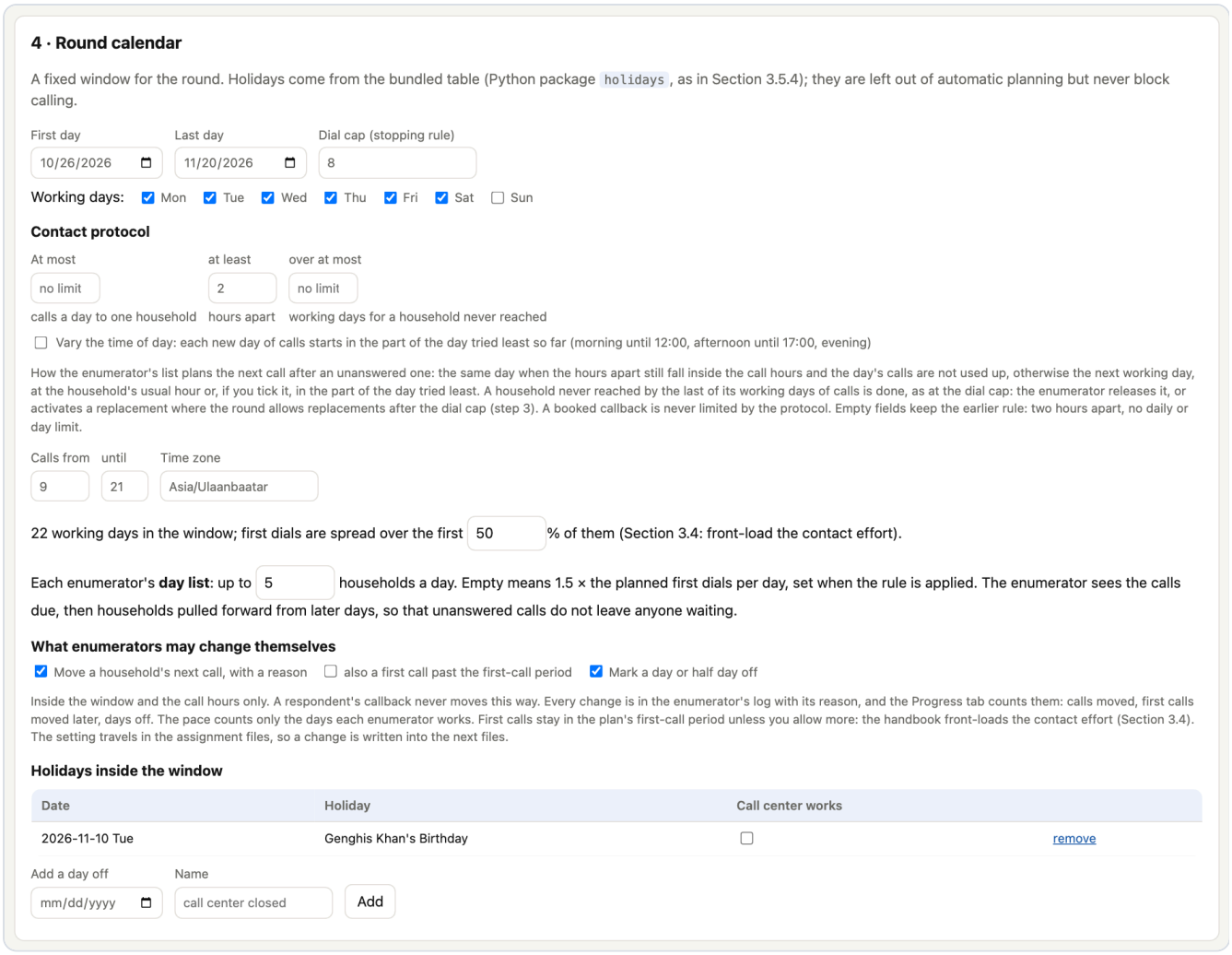


Figure B6. The round calendar: 22 working days, with the 10 November holiday.

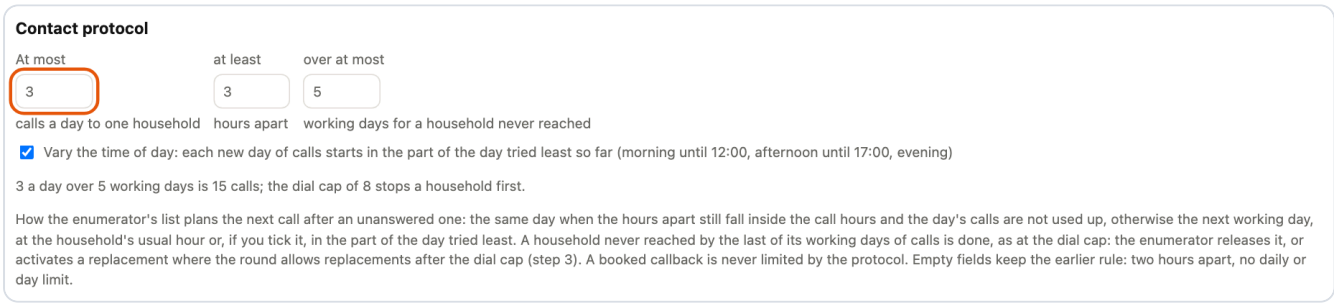


Figure B6a. A contact protocol of three calls a day, three hours apart, over five working days at varied times of day: 15 calls, set against the dial cap.

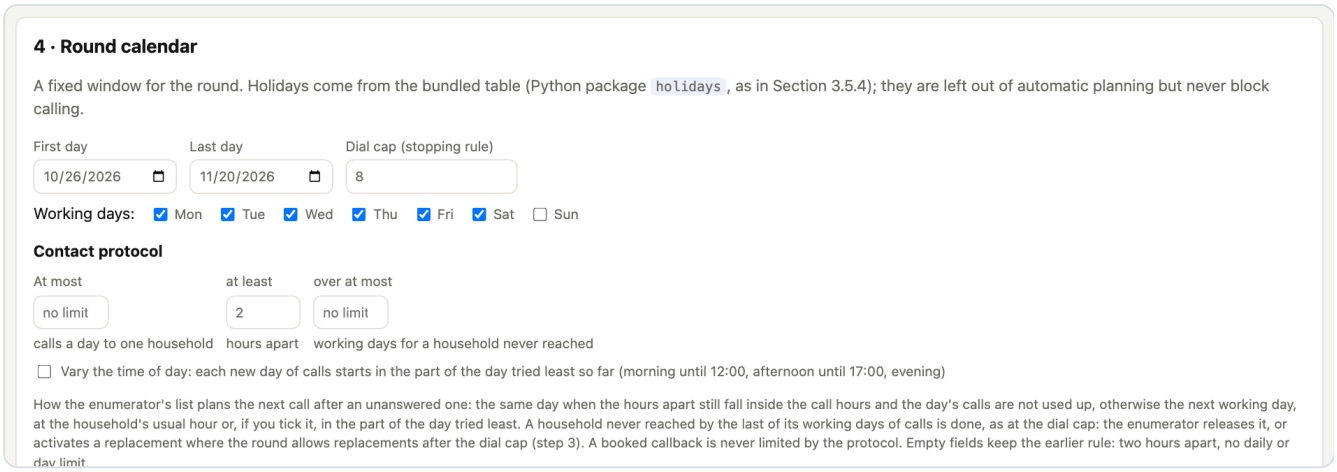


Figure B6b. The day list after the rule is applied: the plan's first dials per enumerator per day, and the default of 1.5 × that.

When the window falls in Ramadan, the card also asks for the hour the fast is broken; that hour is kept free of planned calls.

B7 Step 5 · Team

The team comes from the last round's manifest, or is added with **Add an enumerator ID**. For each enumerator:

- untick **Available this round** for someone who is away. They keep their history; their households are dealt to the others with the reason “enumerator unavailable”;
- set a **share**: relative weights (1 each by default), or percentages adding up to 100 under the “share of total” rule;
- **remove** someone who has left.

Matching criteria. Above the table, the card offers the columns of the household list that can decide who calls whom: `language`, and any other column with few distinct values, such as the respondent's sex, a dialect or an area (add the column to the household list; nothing else changes). Tick a criterion and a column appears in the team table: type each enumerator's values, several separated by spaces or commas (`mn kk`). A household then goes only to an enumerator whose values include the household's; a household without a value can go to anyone. Every available enumerator needs a value for every criterion ticked. The criteria and the values are written into the manifest and the assignment files, so the program can say how it assigned, and the next round offers them again.

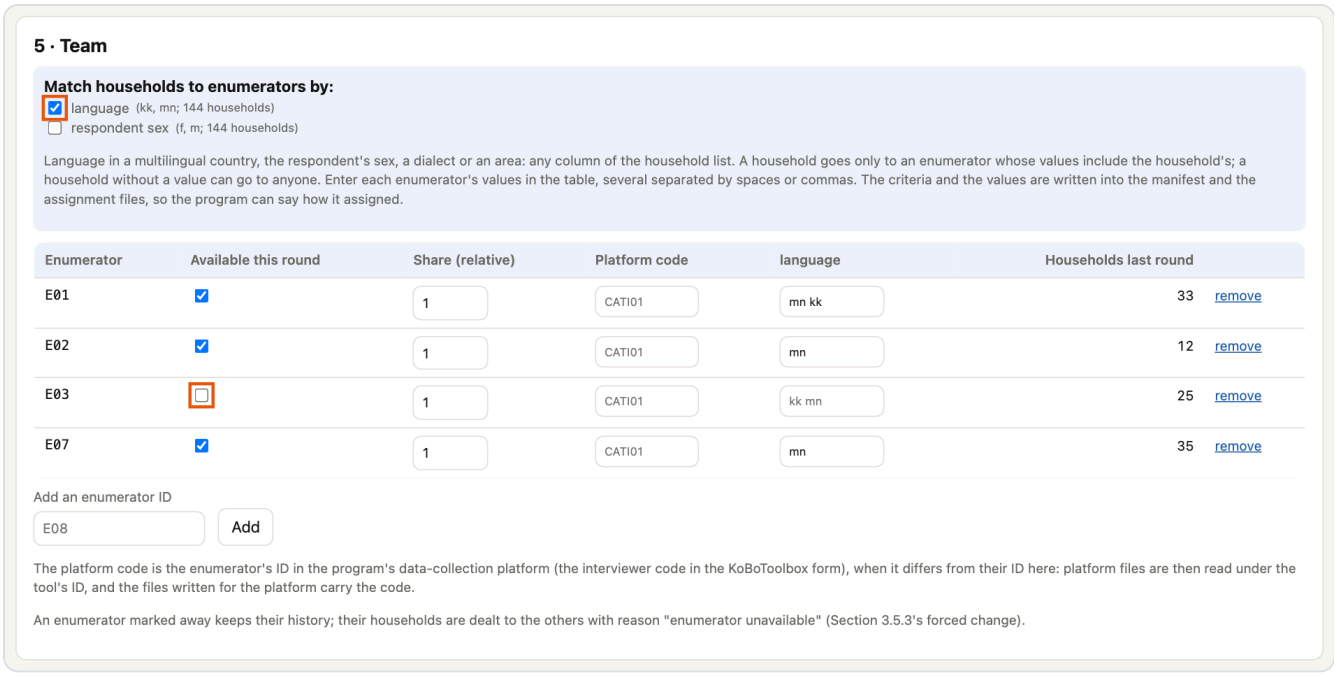


Figure B7. The team, with E03 marked away this round, and the language criterion: E01 speaks Mongolian and Kazakh, the others Mongolian.

B8 Step 6 · Assignment rule

Rule	What it does	When to use it
Keep the same enumerator (default)	Each household stays with the enumerator who completed its last interview. A planned share rotates to another enumerator each round, and a hard-to-reach household is switched. New households are dealt at random	Every round after the first: the handbook's stated default (Section 3.5.3)
Random	Households dealt at random, mixing strata, in proportion to the shares	The first round, or a round where enumerator effects must be estimated
Equal split	Consecutive blocks of the list in a chosen order (PSU, stratum, language or ID), sizes differing by at most one	When enumerators must match a language or an area. Enumerator and area effects then cannot be told apart
Share of total	Like equal split or random, with shares that add up to 100%	Part-time or new enumerators
Manual	A list of `hhid` and `enumerator_id` that you open; households without one, and unknown IDs, are flagged	Special cases

Under the default rule, enter the **rotation share** for this round, for example 10%. It has no default: the handbook calls its size “a judgment, not an estimate from these data”. A household is **hard to reach** when it was not interviewed last round although it received the full dial cap, or when its enumerator asked for a switch.

The **seed** is written into every file, so the same inputs and seed always give the same assignment. Click **Apply the rule**. If something is missing, such as the window or the rotation share, the tool lists it above the button.

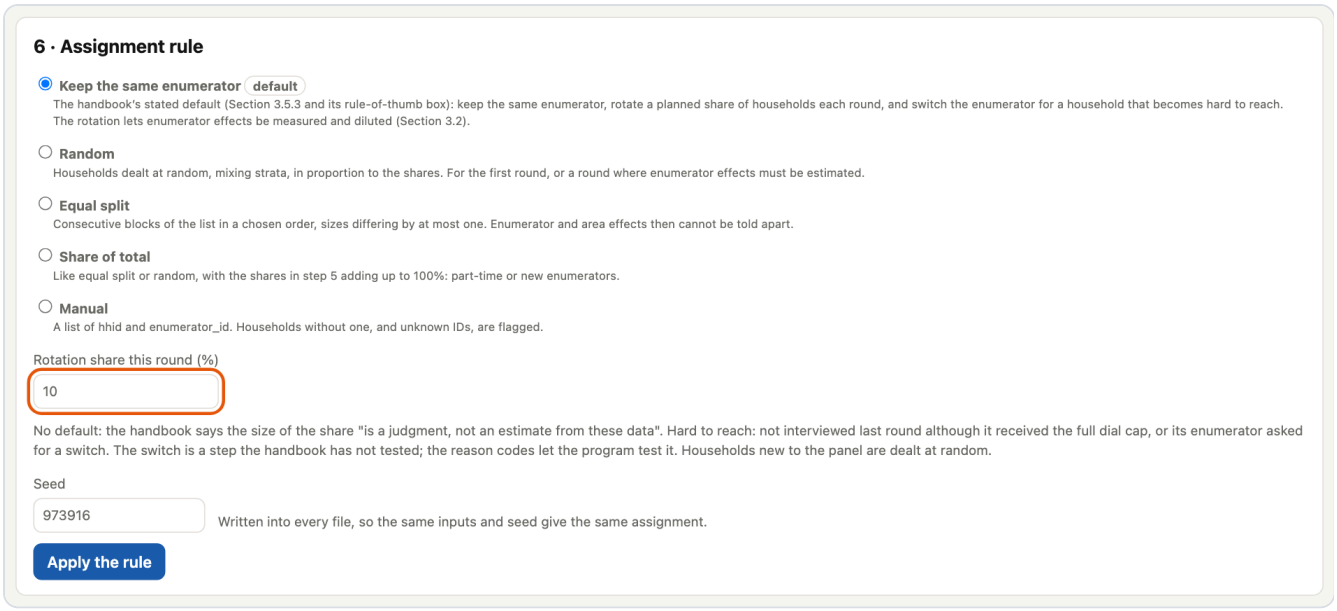


Figure B8. The rules, with the rotation share entered.

> If you change a setting after applying the rule (the team, the seed, the share, the window, the working days or the holidays), the tool sets the assignment and any files written from it aside and asks you to apply the rule again. Files and assignment always match the settings shown.

B9 Step 7 · Check the assignment

Before any file is written, step 7 shows each enumerator's households: by reason (kept, rotation, hard to reach, enumerator away, new, or by the round's rule), by stratum, and in total. It also shows the **expected dials**, computed from each household's dials last round, against the enumerator's target share.

- Loads outside the **margin** (15% by default) are marked. **Move kept households at random to balance** moves kept households from the busiest to the least busy enumerators, with the reason “capacity”, until every load is within the margin.
- Open **Households: move one by hand** to change any household's enumerator; the move is recorded as “by hand”.
- With matching criteria (B7), a kept household whose enumerator does not match moves with the reason “matched”, the balance never moves a household to an enumerator who does not match it, and the card says whether every household is with a matching enumerator. A household that no available enumerator matches is listed at the top of the household table without an enumerator: choose one by hand (it is marked as not matched), or give an enumerator the value in step 5. No file is written while a household has no enumerator.

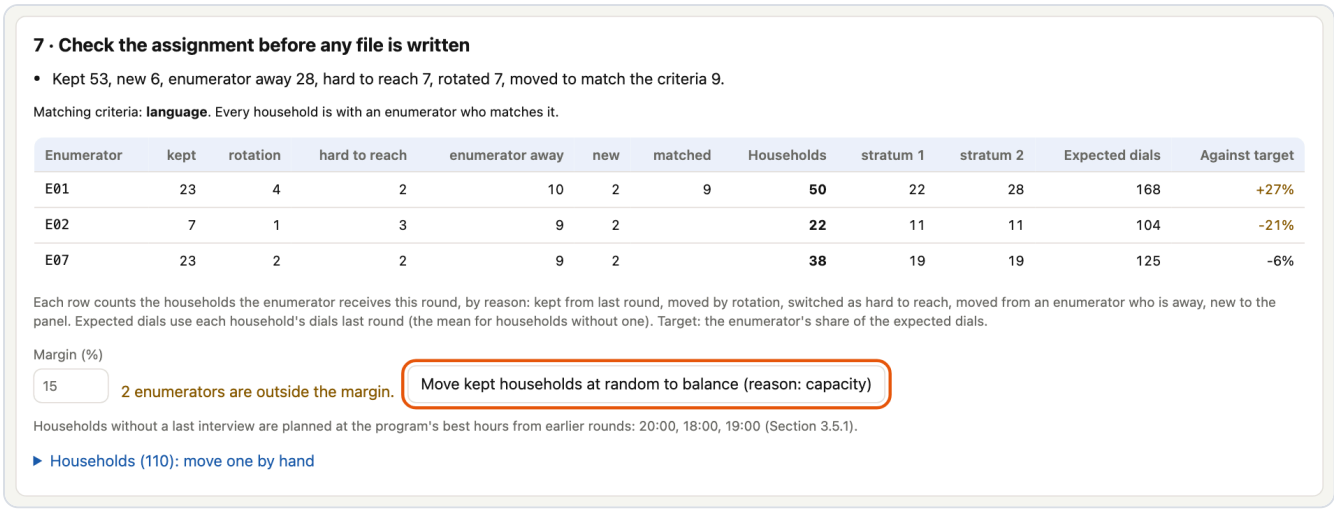


Figure B9. The check, with the language criterion: the households moved to match are counted under “matched”.

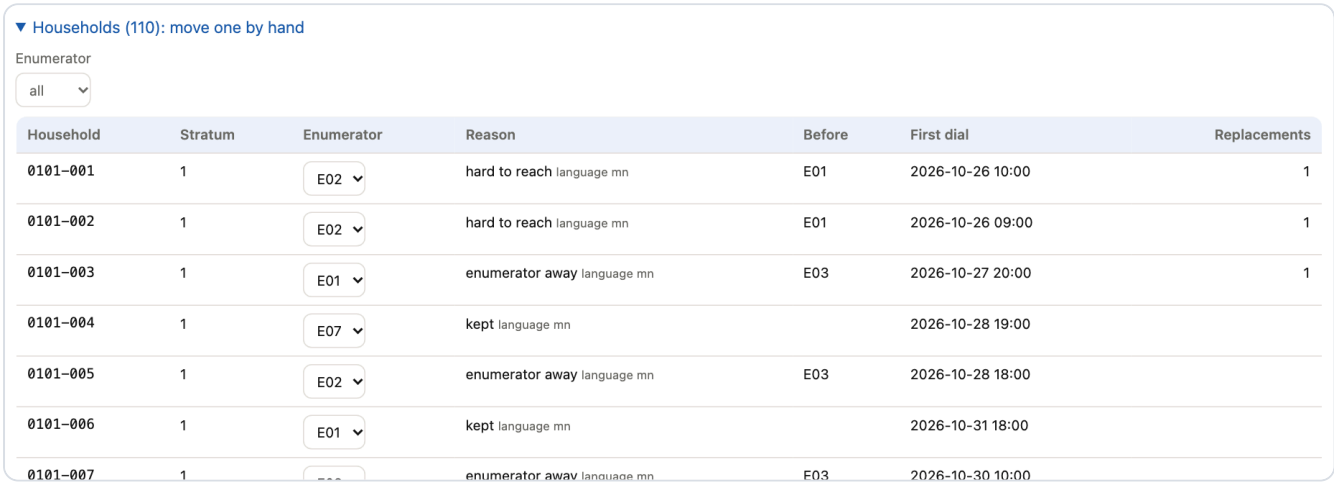


Figure B10. Moving one household by hand.

Households without a last interview are planned at the program's best hours from earlier rounds (Section 3.5.1). New households, households switched as hard to reach and households in the high dropout tier (B18) get the earliest first dials.

B10 Step 8 · Write and give out the files

1. Tick **Protect each assignment file with its own passphrase** if a file could end up in the wrong place. The tool makes one passphrase per enumerator and shows them once: copy them or click **Download the passphrase list**. They are not saved anywhere.
2. Click **Write the files**. If some loads are still outside the margin, a reminder names them; you can still write.
3. Click **Save all into a folder** (Chrome) or **Download all**.

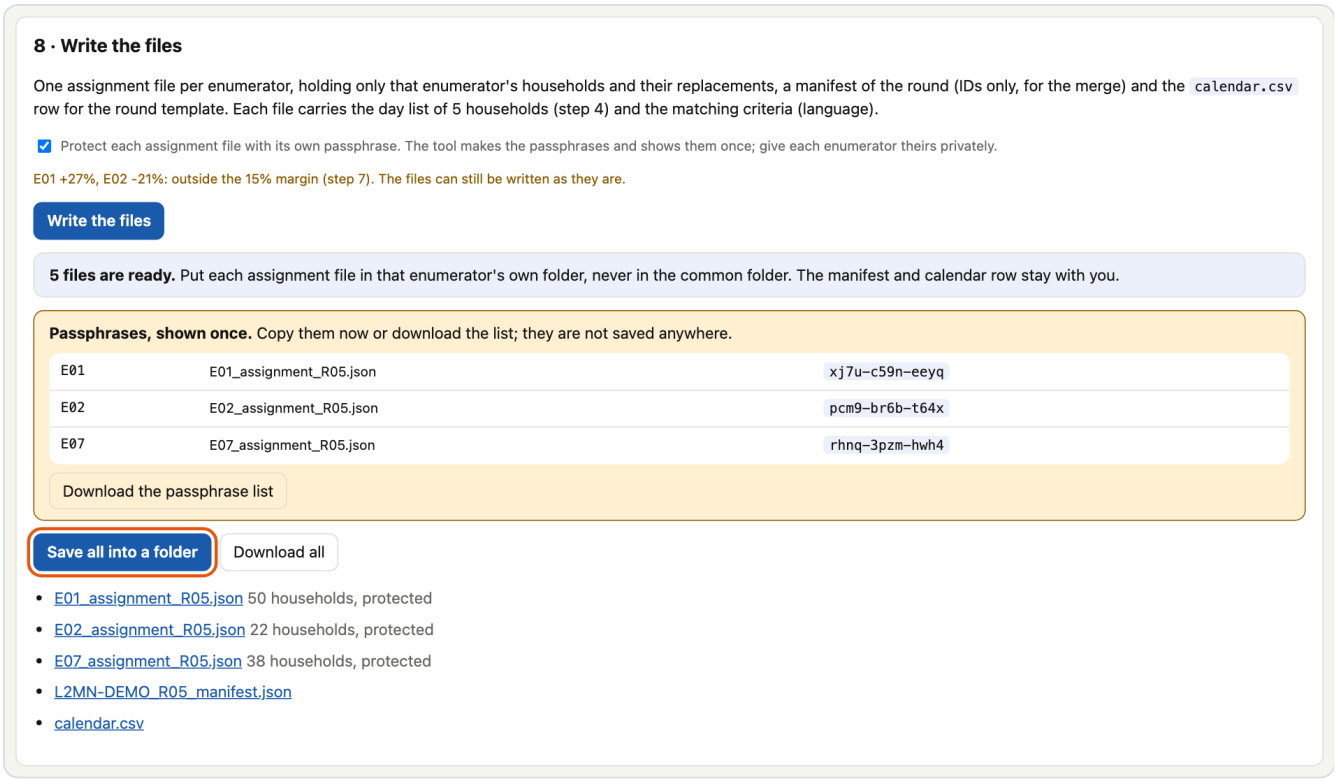


Figure B11. Five files ready, with the passphrases shown once.

File	Where it goes
`E01_assignment_R05.json`, one per enumerator	Into that enumerator's own folder, never the common folder. Give the passphrase separately, privately
`L2MN-DEMO_R05_manifest.json`	Stays with you: the merge checks every export against it (IDs only)
`calendar.csv`	The round's row for the handbook's round template

> Each assignment file holds only its enumerator's households and their replacements, with their contacts. No file carries another enumerator's contact information.

B11 Save and close the session

Click **Save leader session** to keep the inputs, settings, imports and every decision in one file, `leader_L2MN-DEMO_R05.json`. To protect it, type a passphrase twice; leave both empty to save it unprotected. The file holds the household list with its contacts: keep it in your own folder.

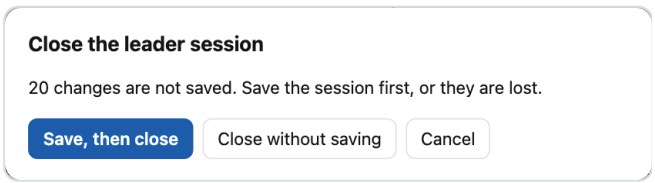


Figure B13. Closing with unsaved changes.

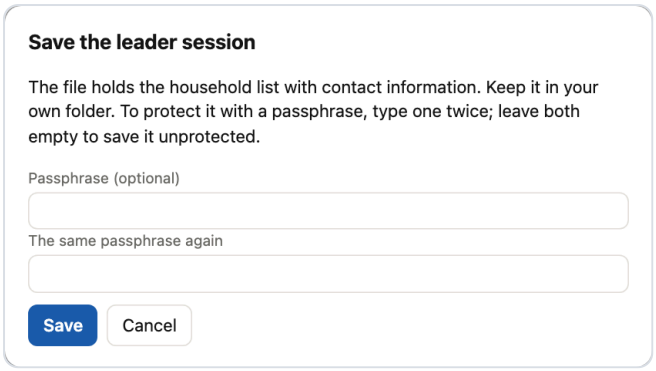


Figure B12. Saving the leader session.

B12 Import the exports

Whenever you want to see progress, open the **Import logs** tab.

1. If the session has no manifest yet (for example a new session for importing only), click **Open a round manifest** and choose the manifest written in step 8.
2. Click **Add files** and choose the enumerators' exports from the common folder, all at once: their `.json` and `.csv` files, and any contacts files they gave you. Adding older exports does no harm: the newest export of each enumerator is used.



Figure B14. A session without a manifest asks for one.

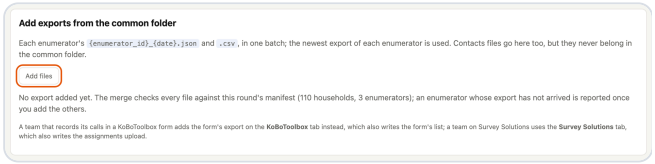


Figure B15. Adding the exports.

B13 Merge questions and the merge report

The merge never decides silently. Each situation it finds is a line in the merge report; those that need you appear under **Needs your decision**, with a button for each choice and an optional note. A decision is logged with who took it and when, and can be reviewed in the report.

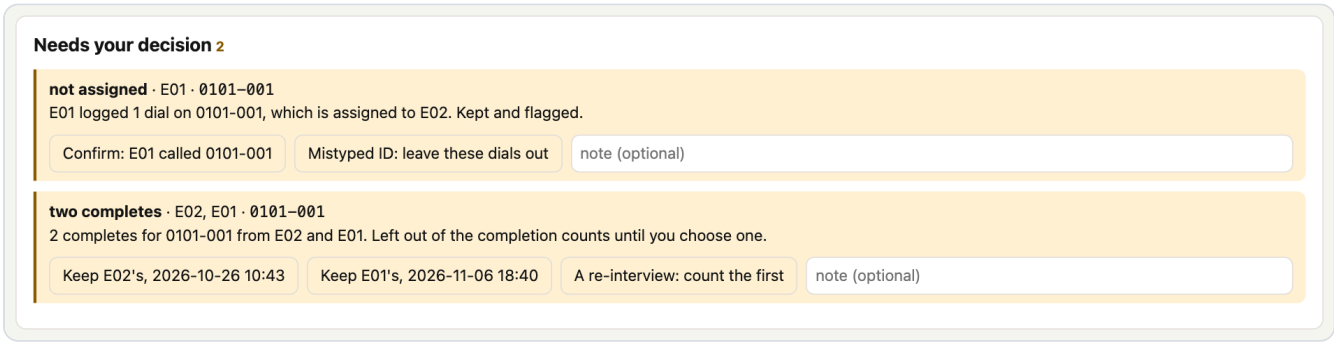
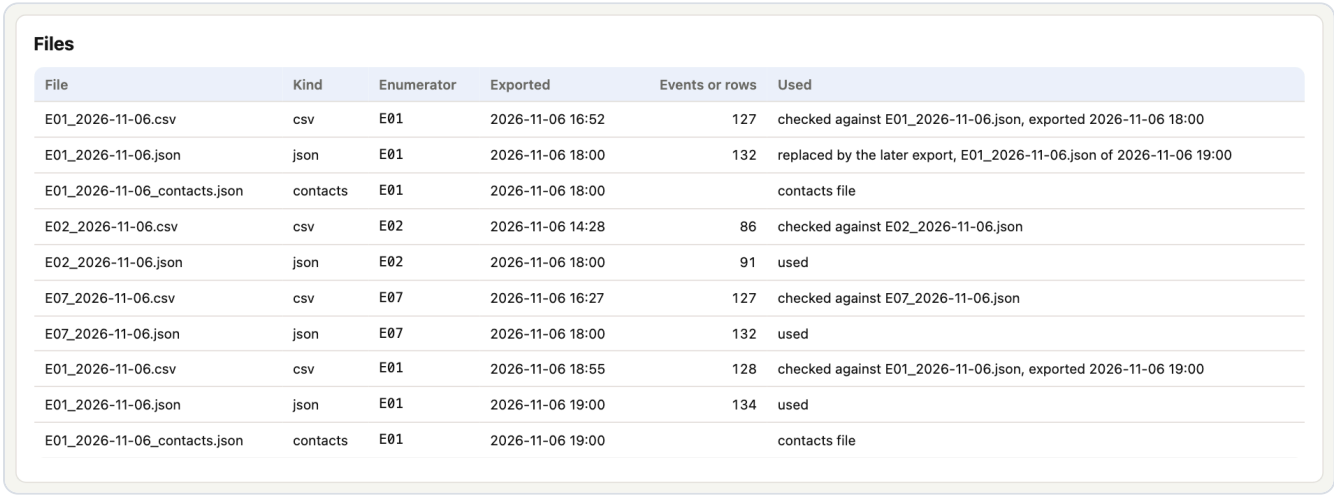


Figure B16. Two questions: dials on a household assigned to someone else, and two completes for one household.

Situation	What the tool does	What you decide

No export from an enumerator	Their households show as “not reported”, apart from completes and misses	Ask for the export
The same file added twice	The copy is ignored and noted	Nothing
Two exports from one enumerator	The later export is used; the earlier is noted. Dials the later one lacks are kept and flagged	For a gap: keep the dials, or leave them out if they were voided
Dials on a household assigned to someone else	Kept and flagged	Confirm the call, or mark a mistyped ID
Two completes for one household	Both kept, left out of the completion counts	Keep one, or count a re-interview
A file changed after export	Its integrity check fails; a differing entry is left out of the counts	Choose which version to use
A file from another round or program	Not merged	Open it in that round's session
A CSV without its JSON	Used as unverified when it is the latest export	Ask for the JSON when possible
Times that cannot be right	Flagged, kept	Check the enumerator's computer clock

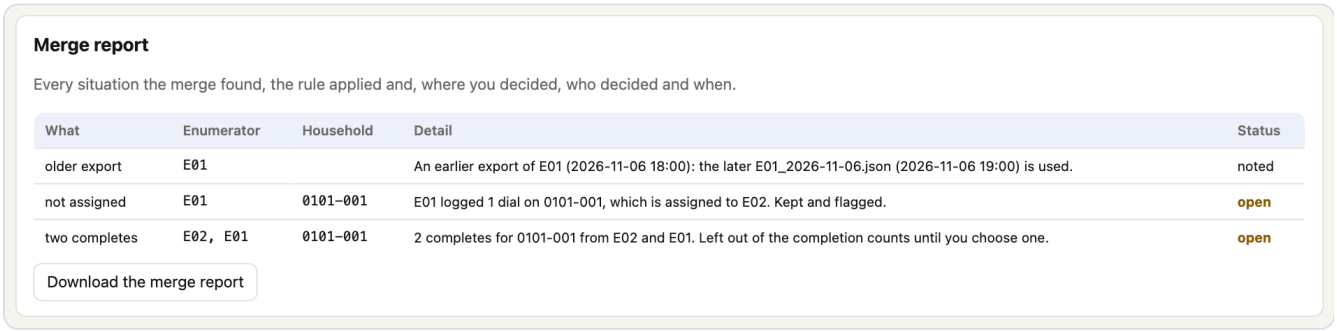
The **Files** table shows how each file was used. **Download the merge report** keeps the record of every situation, the rule applied and your decisions.



Files

File	Kind	Enumerator	Exported	Events or rows	Used
E01_2026-11-06.csv	csv	E01	2026-11-06 16:52	127	checked against E01_2026-11-06.json, exported 2026-11-06 18:00
E01_2026-11-06.json	json	E01	2026-11-06 18:00	132	replaced by the later export, E01_2026-11-06.json of 2026-11-06 19:00
E01_2026-11-06_contacts.json	contacts	E01	2026-11-06 18:00		contacts file
E02_2026-11-06.csv	csv	E02	2026-11-06 14:28	86	checked against E02_2026-11-06.json
E02_2026-11-06.json	json	E02	2026-11-06 18:00	91	used
E07_2026-11-06.csv	csv	E07	2026-11-06 16:27	127	checked against E07_2026-11-06.json
E07_2026-11-06.json	json	E07	2026-11-06 18:00	132	used
E01_2026-11-06.csv	csv	E01	2026-11-06 18:55	128	checked against E01_2026-11-06.json, exported 2026-11-06 19:00
E01_2026-11-06.json	json	E01	2026-11-06 19:00	134	used
E01_2026-11-06_contacts.json	contacts	E01	2026-11-06 19:00		contacts file

Figure B17. The files of a batch and how each was used.



Merge report

Every situation the merge found, the rule applied and, where you decided, who decided and when.

What	Enumerator	Household	Detail	Status
older export	E01		An earlier export of E01 (2026-11-06 18:00): the later E01_2026-11-06.json (2026-11-06 19:00) is used.	noted
not assigned	E01	0101-001	E01 logged 1 dial on 0101-001, which is assigned to E02. Kept and flagged.	open
two completes	E02, E01	0101-001	2 completes for 0101-001 from E02 and E01. Left out of the completion counts until you choose one.	open

Download the merge report

Figure B18. The merge report on screen.

B14 New or corrected numbers

Numbers that enumerators added or corrected arrive in their contacts files. **Download contact updates** gives them in one table; move them into the household list for the next round. The file holds phone numbers: keep it in your own folder.

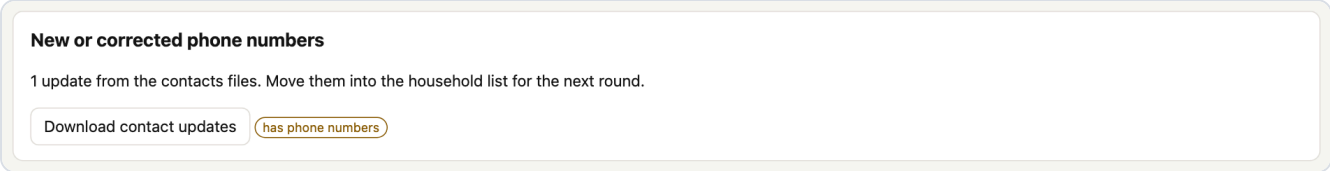


Figure B19. One contact update from the batch.

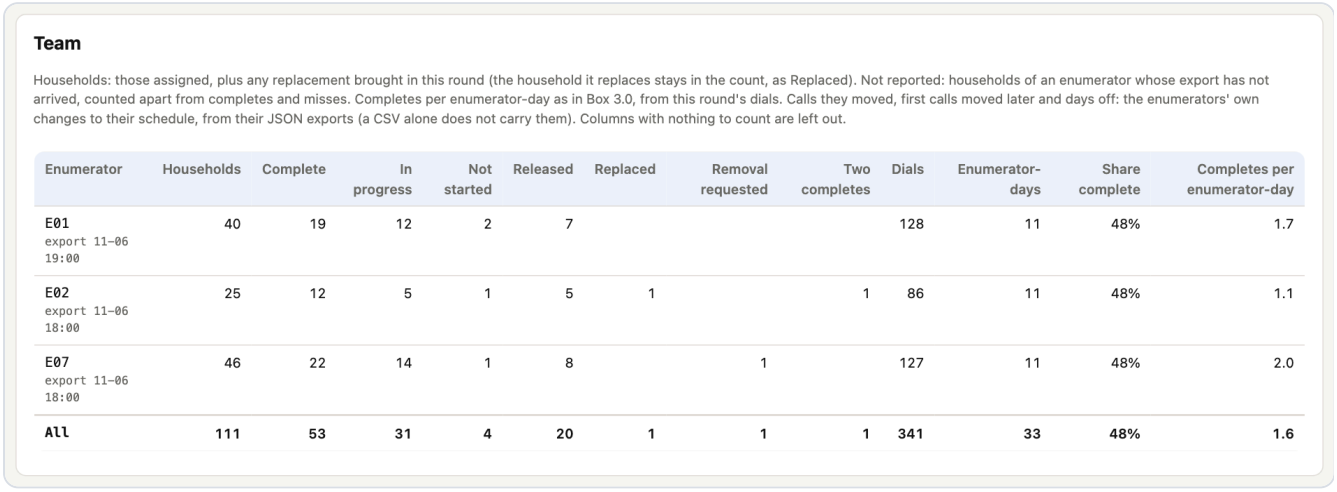
B15 Progress

The **Progress** tab follows the round:

- **Team:** each enumerator's households by state, dials, enumerator-days, share complete and completes per enumerator-day (Box 3.0), with the time of their last export. When enumerators change their own schedule (A23, A24), three more columns count it: the calls they moved, the first calls they moved later, and the days off they marked. A CSV export alone does not carry these; the JSON export does. The pace of *Move waiting households* counts only the days each enumerator works, and names the time off still ahead.
- **Replacement requests**, when you approve replacements (B5): each household an enumerator asked about, with the reason, its dials and last result, and the next replacement in line. Tick requests and click **Release the ticked** or **Decline the ticked** (with a note), then **Write the updated files**: each enumerator concerned gets a revised file, and the manifest records every decision. A released replacement comes into its enumerator's list with its contacts; a declined household opens again. **Release a replacement for household** releases one without a request, for a team on KoBoToolbox or a case you decide yourself; the form's list then carries only released replacements. A replacement used without your release is listed as a merge question (Figure B22e).
- **Blocked numbers** (in *Move waiting households*): households whose last call shows the respondent blocked the caller's number. **Move them to colleagues** lists a move for each, to those with spare days first, then the fewest open, criteria respected.
- **Field visits:** the households an enumerator referred for a visit in person, with the reason, dials and last result. **Download the visit list** (it holds contacts) to plan the visits; record each outcome (reached, a time agreed; a new number; not found; refused at the door; other) with a note, then **Write the updated files**: the outcome reaches the enumerator as your note on the household. A new number goes into the household list (step 1) so that the next files carry it.
- **Change the round:** for what changes after the files are out. A new **last day** (a late start, a holiday week, a deadline moved) reaches every enumerator's revised file, with the holidays of the new days; first calls planned after an earlier last day move to its last working day. **Add households** from the household list that are not yet in the round: each goes to the enumerator you name, or to the one with the fewest open, with a first call on the next working day. **Re-issue the file** of one enumerator who lost their file or its passphrase: a fresh copy, with a new passphrase if files are protected; they open it as a new assignment, and the calls they exported before stay in the common folder.
- **Text-message list:** for a day you choose (the next working day by default), the households to be called that day: first calls planned and callbacks booked. Download it for whoever sends the messages; the

tool sends nothing.

- **Completes over the window:** cumulative completes by day, and completion by stratum.
- **By area:** completes by PSU this round so far, with the same households' completes in the earlier rounds loaded (step 2). Areas with no interview this round and none before come first.
- **Households:** every household with its enumerator, reason, state, dials and last result, filtered by state or enumerator.

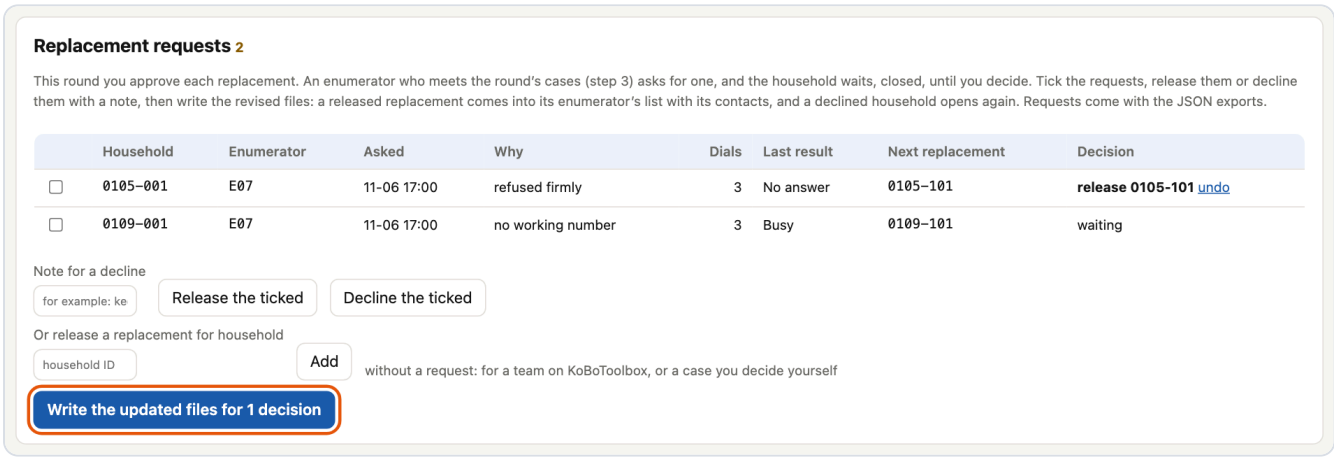


Team

Households: those assigned, plus any replacement brought in this round (the household it replaces stays in the count, as Replaced). Not reported: households of an enumerator whose export has not arrived, counted apart from completes and misses. Completes per enumerator-day as in Box 3.0, from this round's dials. Calls they moved, first calls moved later and days off: the enumerators' own changes to their schedule, from their JSON exports (a CSV alone does not carry them). Columns with nothing to count are left out.

Enumerator	Households	Complete	In progress	Not started	Released	Replaced	Removal requested	Two completes	Dials	Enumerator-days	Share complete	Completes per enumerator-day
E01 export 11-06 19:00	40	19	12	2	7				128	11	48%	1.7
E02 export 11-06 18:00	25	12	5	1	5	1		1	86	11	48%	1.1
E07 export 11-06 18:00	46	22	14	1	8		1		127	11	48%	2.0
All	111	53	31	4	20	1	1	1	341	33	48%	1.6

Figure B20. The team's progress.



Replacement requests 2

This round you approve each replacement. An enumerator who meets the round's cases (step 3) asks for one, and the household waits, closed, until you decide. Tick the requests, release them or decline them with a note, then write the revised files: a released replacement comes into its enumerator's list with its contacts, and a declined household opens again. Requests come with the JSON exports.

	Household	Enumerator	Asked	Why	Dials	Last result	Next replacement	Decision
☐	0105-001	E07	11-06 17:00	refused firmly	3	No answer	0105-101	release 0105-101 undo
☐	0109-001	E07	11-06 17:00	no working number	3	Busy	0109-101	waiting

Note for a decline

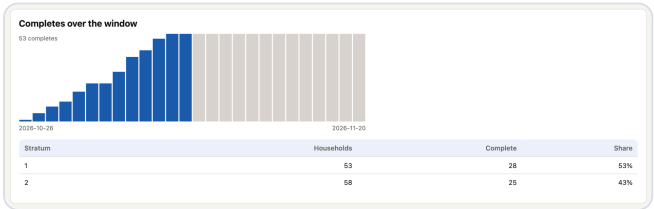
for example: ke | Release the ticked | Decline the ticked

Or release a replacement for household

household ID | Add | without a request: for a team on KoBoToolbox, or a case you decide yourself

Write the updated files for 1 decision

Figure B22e. Two replacement requests from E07: one ticked and set to release its next replacement, ready to write the updated files.



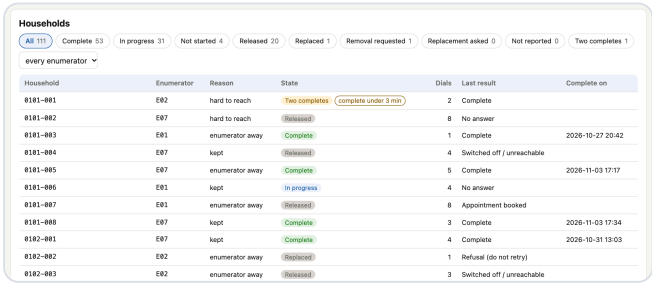
Completes over the window

53 completes

2026-10-26 2026-11-20

Stratum	Households	Complete	Share
1	53	28	53%
2	58	25	43%

Figure B21. Completes by day and by stratum.



Households

All 111 | Complete 53 | In progress 31 | Not started 4 | Released 20 | Replaced 1 | Removal requested 1 | Replacement asked 0 | Not reported 0 | Two completes 1

every enumerator

Household	Enumerator	Reason	State	Dials	Last result	Complete on
0101-001	E02	hard to reach	Two completes complete under 3 min	2	Complete	
0101-002	E07	hard to reach	Released	8	No answer	
0101-003	E01	enumerator away	Complete	1	Complete	2026-10-27 20:42
0101-004	E07	kept	Released	4	Switched off / unreachable	
0101-005	E07	enumerator away	Complete	5	Complete	2026-11-03 17:17
0101-006	E01	kept	In progress	4	No answer	
0101-007	E01	enumerator away	Released	8	Appointment booked	
0101-008	E07	kept	Complete	3	Complete	2026-11-03 17:34
0102-001	E07	kept	Complete	4	Complete	2026-10-31 13:03
0102-002	E02	enumerator away	Replaced	1	Refusal (do not retry)	
0102-003	E02	enumerator away	Released	3	Switched off / unreachable	

Figure B22. The households, with their state.

Move waiting households

Part-way through the round, the card **Move waiting households** shows, for each enumerator, the completes per enumerator-day so far (the pace), how many they can still complete in the working days left, and whether they are **short** or have **spare** days at that pace. Only enumerators whose latest export is from today, with two or more enumerator-days, are judged; tick the box to judge earlier exports too.

1. Choose which households may move: those not yet called (the default), or also those called without a booked callback or a hard refusal. A complete, a released or replaced household and a replacement never move.
2. Click **Propose moves**. Households move one at a time from the enumerator furthest behind to the one with most spare days, until nobody is more than half a household off; the latest-planned households go first, and only to an enumerator who matches their criteria (B7). Untick a move to leave that household where it is, or add one by hand by its ID.
3. Click **Write the updated files**. The tool writes a new assignment file for each enumerator who gives or receives a household (revision 2, 3…) and the next revision of the manifest, which lists every move with when and by whom. Give each file to its enumerator, who opens it with **Load updated assignment** (A20). This needs the household list open in the session (step 1).

No household is in two files, and no double call goes unnoticed: a moved household carries the dials its previous enumerator made, which count toward the dial cap, and in the merge the previous enumerator's dials up to the move are theirs while any made after it is flagged for you to keep or leave out. That holds even for a household moved back to an earlier enumerator: a dial they made while someone else held it is still flagged.

Three more cases

The same card covers what happens to a team during a round. Each adds to the list of moves; “Write the updated files” writes them all in one revision.

- **An enumerator finished early.** With nothing left open, they are judged on any export, not only today's, and “Propose moves” sends them households from the enumerators behind. When nobody is behind but you still want them busy, use **Give … households to**: the number you choose goes to them from the enumerators furthest behind, then from those with most households waiting. If fewer can be given, the card says why (the others' exports are not from today, or nothing is waiting).
- **An enumerator is away** (ill, or has left). Choose them under **An enumerator is away**: every open household of theirs moves to the others, including those with a booked callback, which goes with the household; a hard refusal stays, since nobody calls it again. Households go first to enumerators with spare days, then evenly by the number of households open, and only to one who matches their criteria. The roster marks the enumerator away from that moment, and no proposal sends households to them until you move one to them by hand, which brings them back.
- **An enumerator joins the round.** Open **An enumerator joins the round** and give their ID, name, platform code (C) and, when the round matches by language or another criterion, their values. They enter the roster with the next files you write, with their own assignment file; give them households with **Give … households to** or by hand. Their file is their first: they open it with “Open assignment”.

A move by hand now takes a household with a booked callback too; the callback moves with it. The file for a team that interviews in KoBoToolbox (C4) changes after any of these: write the households list again and paste it into the form, so that a newcomer's households appear under their code and a departed enumerator's under the new holders'.

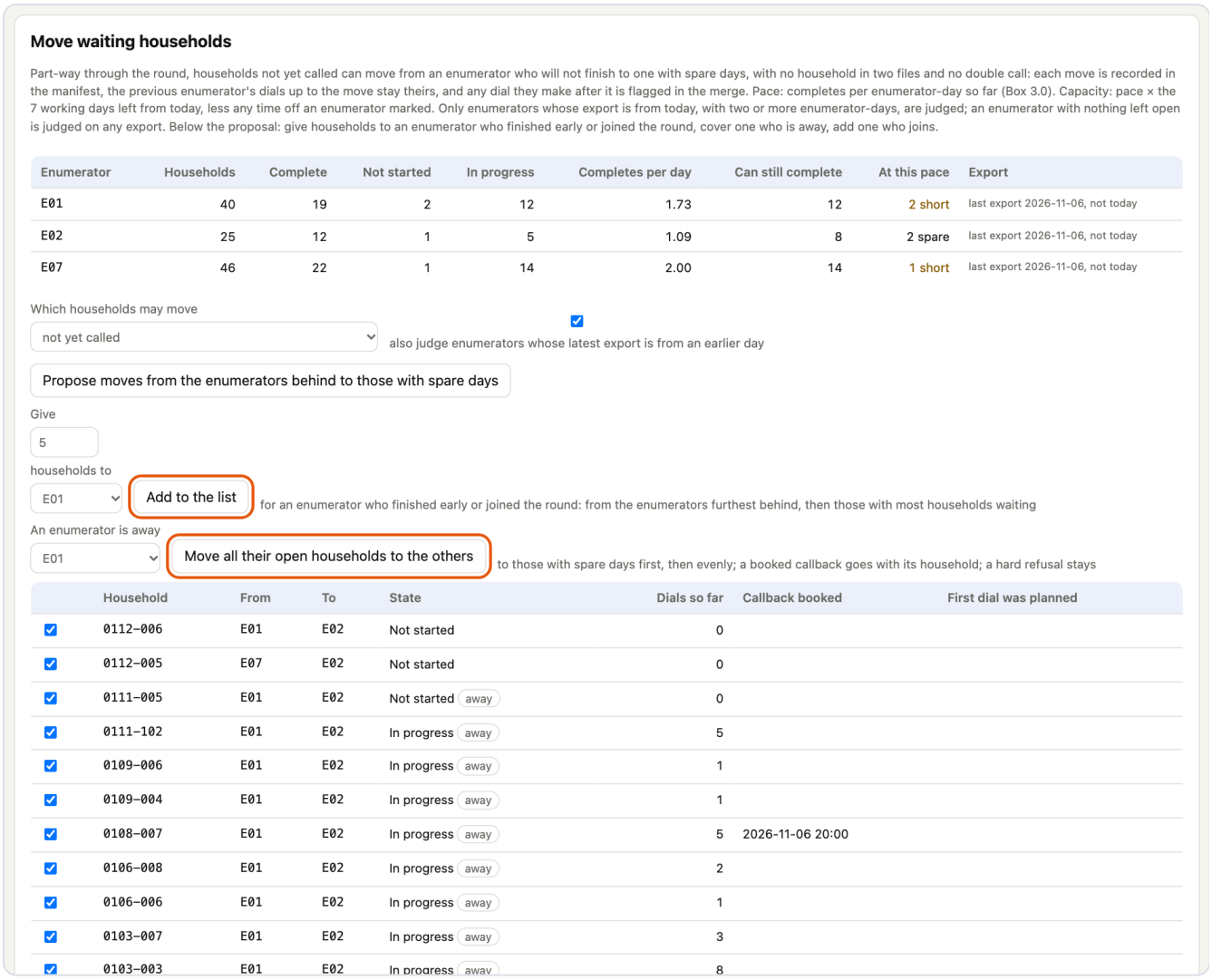


Figure B22d. The three cases on one list. Shown: E01 away, so every open household of theirs goes to the others, tagged “away”, a booked callback (0108-007) going with its household. Further down the same list, E09 has joined with a platform code and been given four households.

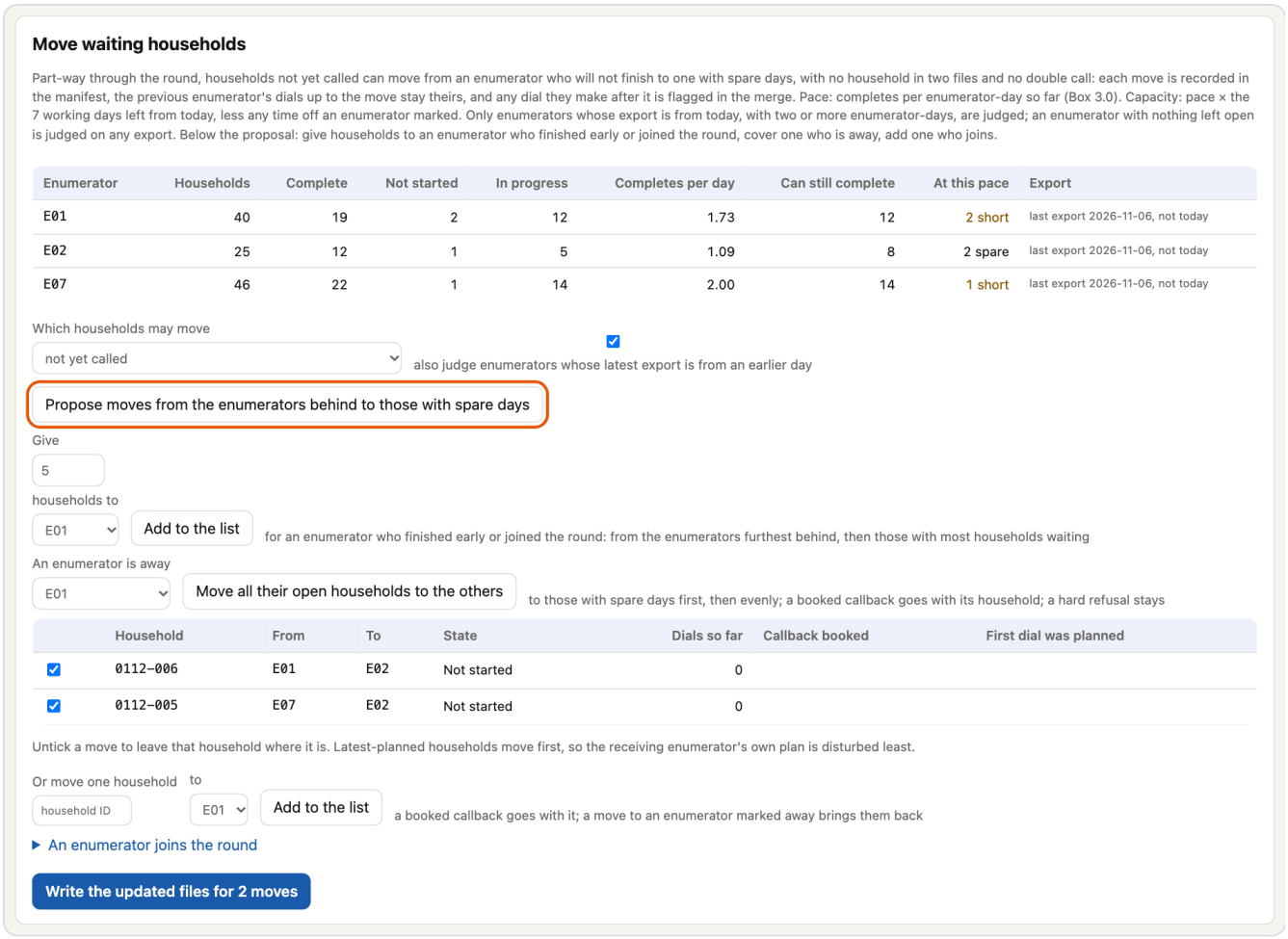


Figure B22b. Who is short and who has spare days, and the moves proposed.

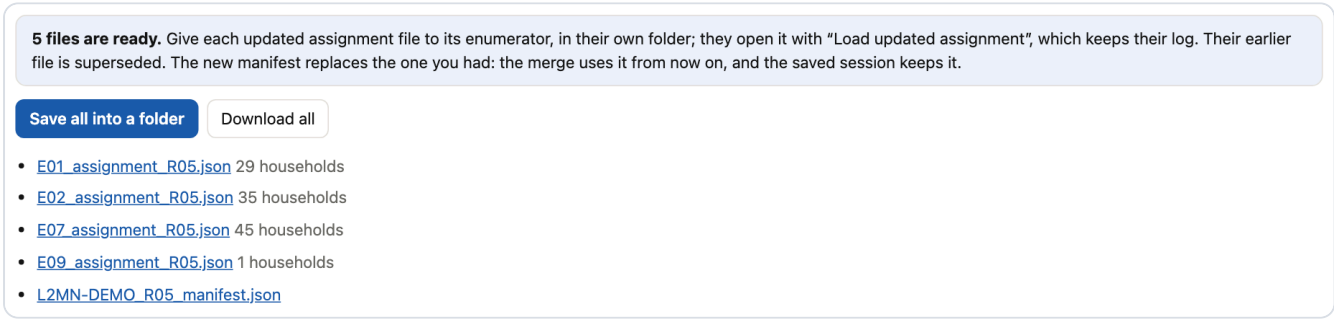


Figure B22c. The revised files and the manifest's next revision, ready to give out.

B16 Call log and the round's files

The **Call log** tab shows the merged call log, filtered by enumerator, result or household, and writes the round's files:

Button	File	Use
Merged call log (CSV)	`L2MN-DEMO_R05_calls.csv`	Every dial, in the handbook's harmonized dial columns; the handbook's analysis scripts and this tool read it as an earlier round
Actions (CSV)	`L2MN-DEMO_R05_actions.csv`	Releases, switch and removal requests, replacements

interviews.csv	`interviews.csv`	One row per household for the handbook's round template (Section 4.2)
outcome_codes.csv	`outcome_codes.csv`	The outcome codes and their meanings, for the template's configuration
calendar.csv	`calendar.csv`	The round's window, for the template
Manifest	`L2MN-DEMO_R05_manifest.json`	The round's assignment, IDs only

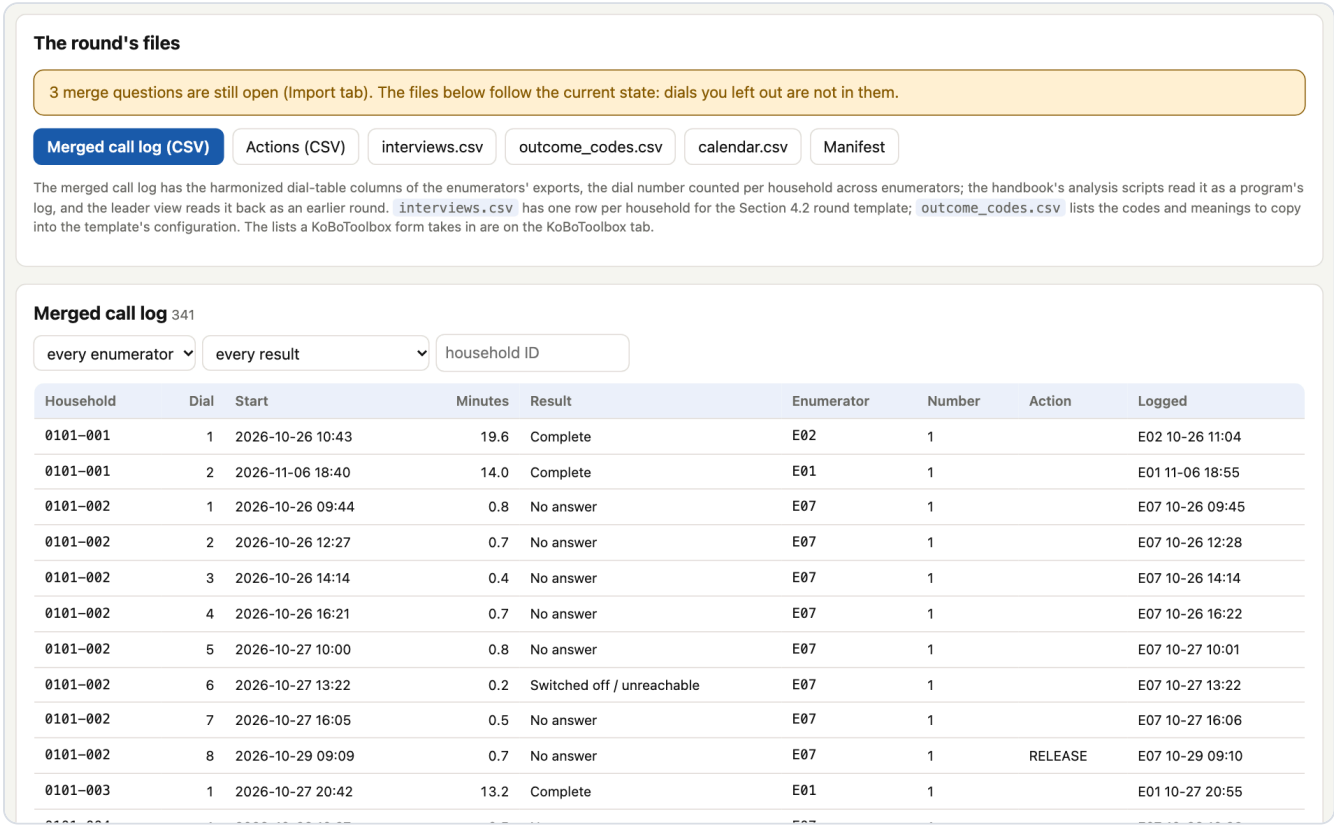


Figure B23. The round's files and the merged call log. While questions are open, the files follow the current state.

B17 Analytics

With earlier rounds loaded (step 2), the **Analytics** tab computes the handbook's measures, with the same definitions as its scripts. All measures are unweighted. The attrition measures use closed rounds only; the round under way appears as “so far”.

Section	Measures
Continuation and retention (Box 2.0, Section 3.4.3)	Continuation round to round, retention of the first-round sample, retention by rounds since joining, cohorts
Loss and returns (Section 3.4.3)	Loss by rounds since joining, returns within three rounds, recruitment waves
Dials per complete (Section 3.3)	Dials per complete, completion, first-dial success, hazard by dial, missed households redialed
Productivity (Section 3.1)	Completes per enumerator-day, dial minutes, attendance, by enumerator

Timing (Section 3.5)	Success by hour, best and busiest hours, weekdays, the first dial against the last interview's time, continuity, holidays, Ramadan

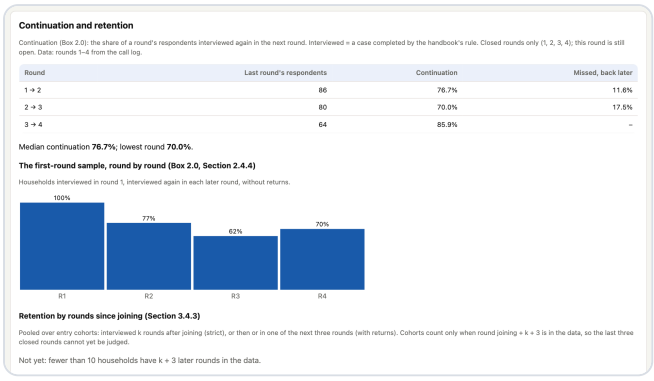


Figure B24. Continuation and retention.



Figure B25. Dials per complete and hazard by dial.

B18 Risk lists

The **Risk lists** tab is for the leader only. Two models rank households to order the work:

- **Dropout risk** ranks last round's respondents by how likely they are to be missed this round. It was trained on the handbook's six programs with dial logs.
- **Return likelihood** ranks the households interviewed two rounds ago and missed last round by how likely they are to come back. It was trained on two programs and is weak: use it only to order redials.

Tiers are tied to workload: within the round, the top 15% by score are high, the next 35% medium and the rest low (the return model has only high and low). A tier says how similar households fared; it is never a prediction about one household and never a reason to drop one (Section 3.3.5). Enumerators never see tiers, and tiers are not written into assignment files; the high dropout tier only gets earlier first dials in the plan. The models use operational features only, never demographic ones.

Each list shows the household, its enumerator, its tier, its score against the round's average, and what moves the score most. Use the tier buttons to filter, and **Download this list** to keep it.

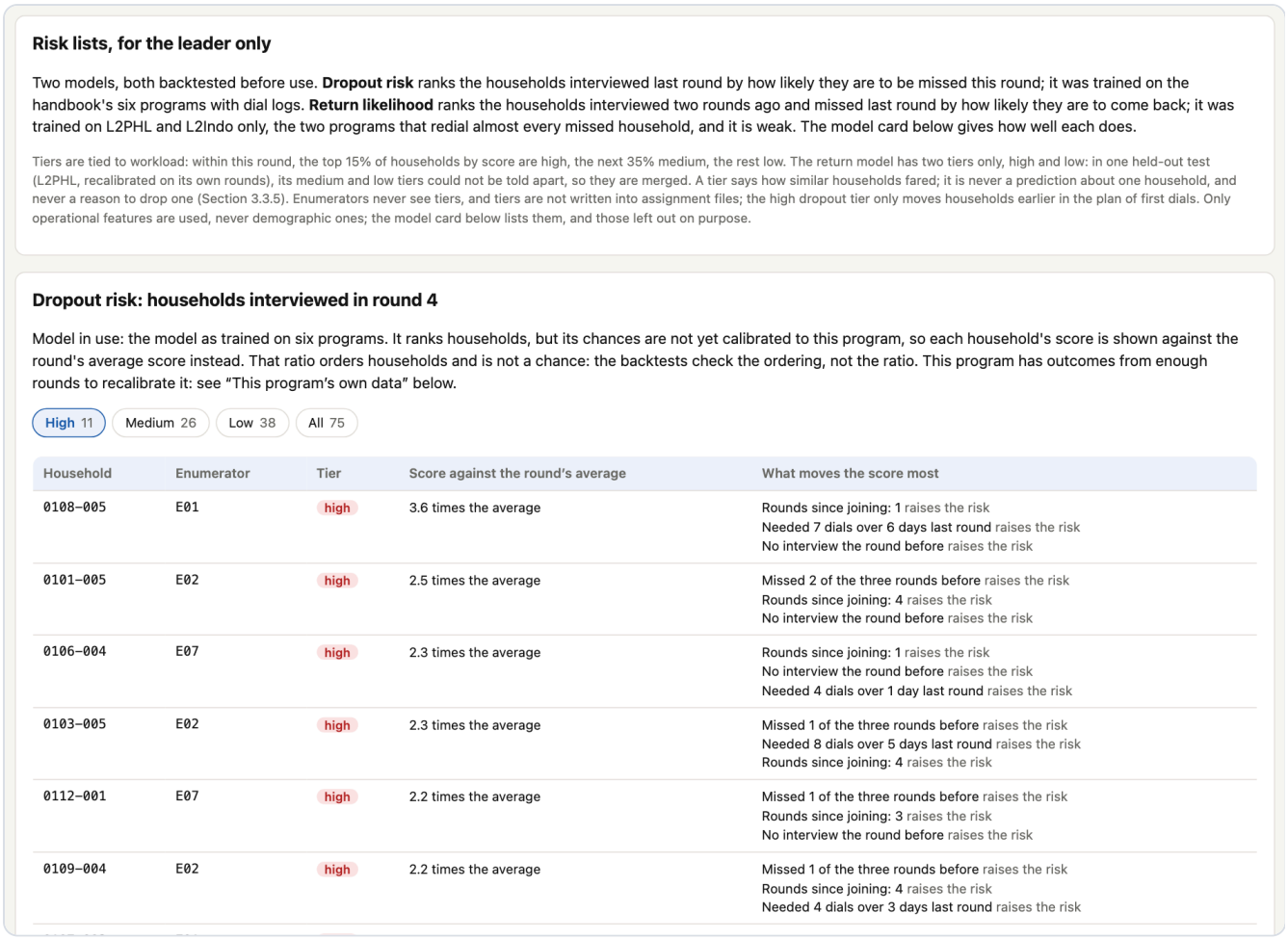


Figure B26. The risk lists: the explanation and the dropout list's high tier.

This program's own data. Applied to a new program, the models rank households usefully but their chances are not calibrated, so the list shows a score, not a chance. Once two rounds have outcomes, click **Backtest on this program's own rounds**. The tool reads the result out in words, from the backtest's 95% interval:

- "too few outcomes to judge": keep the version in use and backtest again after the next round;
- "worse than chance": do not use the lists for this program;
- otherwise it says whether the recalibrated version brings the chances closer to what happened.

Choose **use** on a version only if the backtest supports it; the switch is logged. The model card at the bottom of the tab gives the training data, the features, the backtests and the models' limits.

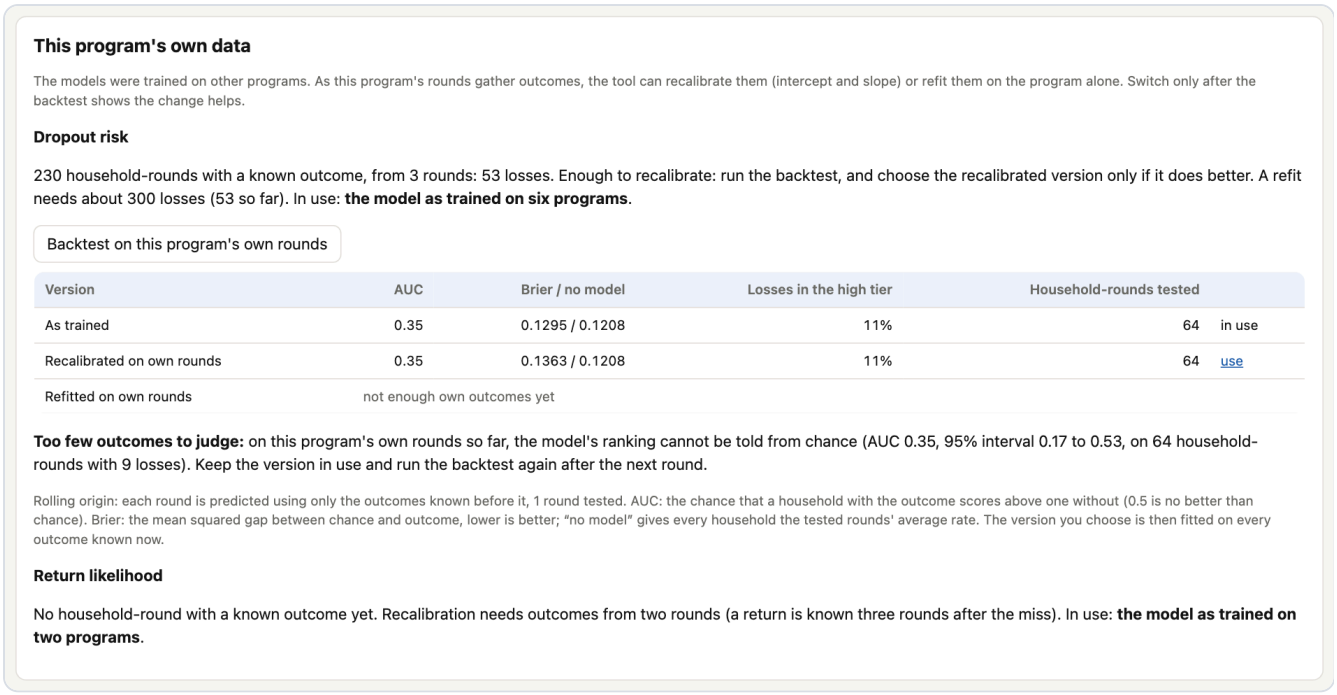


Figure B27. The own-round backtest on the practice program: too few outcomes to judge.

B19 A round, step by step

When	Leader	Enumerators
Before the round	Steps 1 to 8; give out the files and passphrases; save the session	Open their assignment; check the Today tab and the Calendar
Each working day	Import the exports; settle merge questions; read Progress	Call, log, save; export at the end of the day
When an enumerator is away, finishes early or joins	Progress tab, "Move waiting households": cover the one away, give households to the one who is free or new; write the updated files	Load the updated assignment (a newcomer opens their first file)
End of the round	Import the final exports; write the round's files; move contact updates into the household list	Export a final time
Next round	Load this round's merged files as an earlier round (step 2)	Open the new assignment

B20 Messages and what to do

Message	What to do
"Enter the rotation share for this round…"	Enter a share under the default rule; it has no default
"Set the dial cap, the program's stopping rule (step 4)."	Enter the dial cap; a first round has no earlier manifest to take it from
"A setting changed after the rule was applied…"	Click Apply the rule again, then write the files again

“… IDs were written in scientific notation…”	Update rtmtools in Stata (`ado update rtmtools, update`) and export the selection again
“No export from E07 for this round.”	Ask the enumerator to export, then add the file
A file's integrity check fails	Ask for a fresh export; choose a version for each differing entry

Part C · With KoBoToolbox

When enumerators record their calls in a KoBoToolbox form rather than in this tool

C1 When this part applies

Every L2 program interviews in KoBoToolbox. The Philippines program also submits its interview form once per call attempt, whether or not anyone answered, so its call log sits in the form itself; with this tool for the leader's side, a program like it needs KoBoToolbox and no other system, and this part follows that program's form as the worked example. The leader's side of the tool works as in Part B: you prepare the round, give the form its list of households, import each day's export, follow progress and move households during the round. The tool reads the form's export as it is and writes the list in the form's own layout. Nothing is typed twice.

Everything that crosses the boundary sits on one tab, **KoBoToolbox**, which walks the round's cycle in five steps (Figure C1): the form and the interviewers' codes in it (1); the list going to the form before the round (2); the form's export coming in each day (3); the list again after households have moved (4); and the records to look at in KoBoToolbox (5). What a program needs: its form as it is, the household list in the tool's columns (B3), the team (B7) with each interviewer's code in the form, and, for a form the tool does not know, the mapping of its columns and codes once (C3). Section 5 of the Introduction says why the two go together, who records what, and which files cross between them.

> **Platform codes.** Where the form knows an interviewer by another code than their ID here (an interviewer number such as CATI07), enter it in step 1 of the KoBoToolbox tab, or on the Prepare tab, step 5, **Platform code**: the two are the same column. A code entered before the files are written goes into the manifest; one entered later is kept in the session. The tool then reads the form's records under the enumerator's ID, whatever the case or punctuation of the code, and writes the code into the list it gives the form. Several codes for one interviewer, separated by commas (an old code, a typing slip), are all read as that interviewer; the first is the one written into the list.

C2 The Philippines form: one submission per call attempt

The form asks, before the interview, the interviewer's ID, the household (picked from the sample list in the form's choices sheet), the attempt number and whether someone answered; after the interview or instead of it, the result of the call in ten codes (complete; partially complete with or without a callback; not started, callback scheduled; refused; nobody answering; number does not exist; phone off; household unknown; reference person cannot connect) and remarks. KoBoToolbox adds the time the form was opened and submitted.

Download the data (Data › Downloads › CSV with *XML values and headers*, or the project's synchronous export link) and add it under **Add the form's export**, step 3 of the KoBoToolbox tab (Figure C2). The tool recognises the columns, reads each submission as one dial with the result mapped onto the codes of Part A (R1). As in the program's own processing, a complete is code 1 with the respondent's consent; a "partially complete, no more callback" closes the case as a firm refusal does, with the form's label in the note. The tool then splits the file by interviewer and merges each part as it merges a CSV export (B13): unverified, cumulative, the latest file used, every merge question raised where it applies. A complete needs a form open for three minutes or more.

What goes back: step 2 writes **choices_households.csv**, the sample list in the layout of the form's choices sheet, one row per household and unused replacement, with the interviewer's platform code in `filter_int_id` (Figure C1). Paste it over the form's list and redeploy. The form's choices sheet already has the `filter_int_id` column; with a `choice_filter` of `filter_int_id = ${int_id}` on the household question, each interviewer sees only their households. The list has no phone numbers.

C3 A form the tool does not know

A file whose columns match none of the known layouts is not merged; step 3 shows a card for it instead (Figure C3). Each row must be one call attempt. Say which column plays each role (household, enumerator, start and result are needed; end, attempt, callback, number dialed, round, record ID, submission time and note are optional), and what each value of the result column means, chosen from the results of R1; the card lists the values with their counts. **Save the mapping and merge the file** keeps the mapping in your session, so that every later file with the same columns is read without asking. When the Philippines form, or the tool's own, gives a result value its built-in map does not know (a code added when the form was redeployed), step 3 lists the value with its count and asks what it means; the answer is kept in your session. A number dialed becomes the household's slot (number 1, 2 or 3) through the household list, which must be open; the number itself is not kept.

C4 A round, day by day

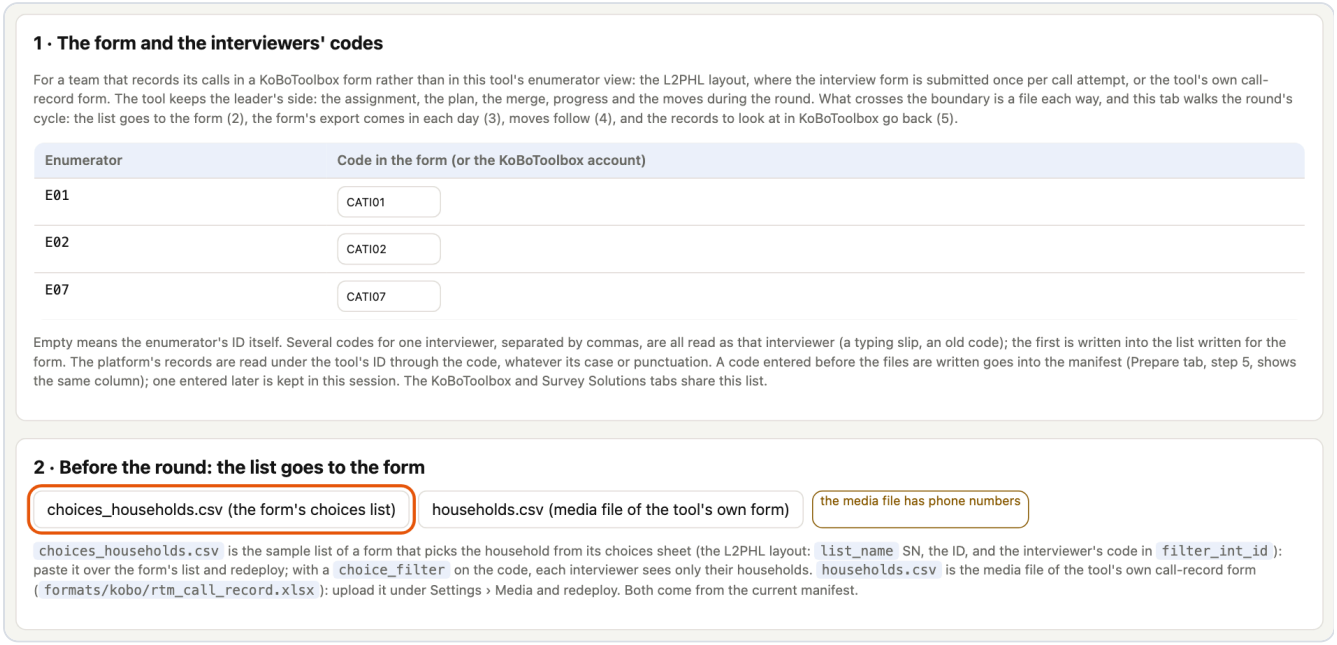
1. **Before the round.** Prepare it as in B3 to B10, with each interviewer's platform code. In step 2 of the KoBoToolbox tab, write `choices_households.csv` (a form with its list in the choices sheet, as the Philippines form) or `households.csv` (the tool's own form, C5), and give it to the form.
2. **Each day.** Download the form's export and add it in step 3. Progress (B15), the call log (B16) and the analytics (B17) follow, and every merge question of B13 is raised where it applies: a call on another interviewer's household, two completes, a call after a move, an interviewer without records; step 3 lists the open ones too.
3. **Part-way through.** Move households on the Progress tab (B15, *Move waiting households*). Step 4 then writes the list again: give it to the form and redeploy, batching the day's moves, since a redeploy reaches the interviewers only when they reload the form. The moved households appear with their new interviewer, and a call the previous interviewer makes after the move is flagged as a double call.
4. **When a merge question concerns a submission.** Step 5 lists every dial behind a merge question with the form's own record ID (`_uuid`), so that you can find the submission in the project's table view, set its validation status or ask the interviewer.
5. **Next round.** The merged call log and the actions file of this round are the history the next round's assignment reads (B4), as they are for a team that logs calls in this tool.

C5 Without a form of its own

A team without a form of its own can use the tool's call-record form, `formats/kobo/rtm_call_record.xlsx` : one submission per call, the household picked from the media file `households.csv` that step 2 writes (one row per household and unused replacement, with the interviewer, the numbers, the planned first dial and the replacement links), the number dialed, start, end, the tool's result codes, the willingness to take part, a callback, an action and a note. Upload the form as a new

project and the media file under Settings › Media, and deploy; replace the media file and redeploy each round and after moves. It has not been deployed to a real project.

C6 What the leader sees



1 · The form and the interviewers' codes

For a team that records its calls in a KoBoToolbox form rather than in this tool's enumerator view: the L2PHL layout, where the interview form is submitted once per call attempt, or the tool's own call-record form. The tool keeps the leader's side: the assignment, the plan, the merge, progress and the moves during the round. What crosses the boundary is a file each way, and this tab walks the round's cycle: the list goes to the form (2), the form's export comes in each day (3), moves follow (4), and the records to look at in KoBoToolbox go back (5).

Enumerator	Code in the form (or the KoBoToolbox account)
E01	CATI01
E02	CATI02
E07	CATI07

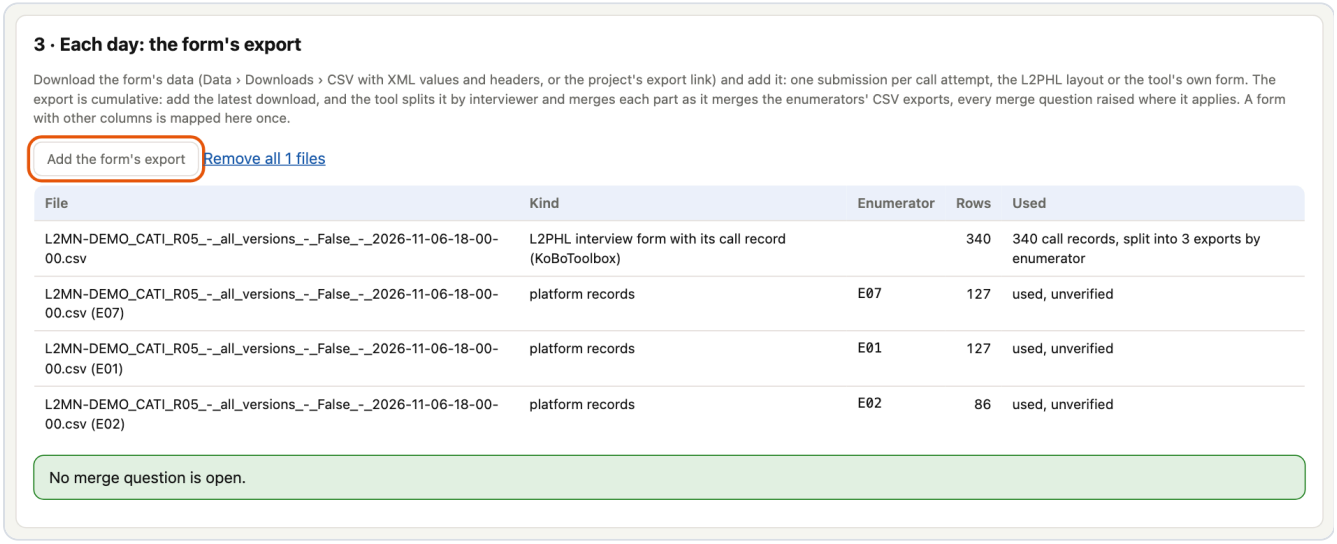
Empty means the enumerator's ID itself. Several codes for one interviewer, separated by commas, are all read as that interviewer (a typing slip, an old code); the first is written into the list written for the form. The platform's records are read under the tool's ID through the code, whatever its case or punctuation. A code entered before the files are written goes into the manifest (Prepare tab, step 5, shows the same column); one entered later is kept in this session. The KoBoToolbox and Survey Solutions tabs share this list.

2 · Before the round: the list goes to the form

choices_households.csv (the form's choices list) | households.csv (media file of the tool's own form) | the media file has phone numbers

`choices_households.csv` is the sample list of a form that picks the household from its choices sheet (the L2PHL layout: `list_name` SN, the ID, and the interviewer's code in `filter_int_id`): paste it over the form's list and redeploy; with a `choice_filter` on the code, each interviewer sees only their households. `households.csv` is the media file of the tool's own call-record form (`formats/kobo/rtm_call_record.xlsx`): upload it under Settings › Media and redeploy. Both come from the current manifest.

Figure C1. The KoBoToolbox tab, steps 1 and 2: the interviewers' codes, and the lists written for the form from the current manifest.



3 · Each day: the form's export

Download the form's data (Data › Downloads › CSV with XML values and headers, or the project's export link) and add it: one submission per call attempt, the L2PHL layout or the tool's own form. The export is cumulative: add the latest download, and the tool splits it by interviewer and merges each part as it merges the enumerators' CSV exports, every merge question raised where it applies. A form with other columns is mapped here once.

Add the form's export | Remove all 1 files

File	Kind	Enumerator	Rows	Used
L2MN-DEMO_CATI_R05_-_all_versions_-_False_-_2026-11-06-18-00-00.csv	L2PHL interview form with its call record (KoBoToolbox)		340	340 call records, split into 3 exports by enumerator
L2MN-DEMO_CATI_R05_-_all_versions_-_False_-_2026-11-06-18-00-00.csv (E07)	platform records	E07	127	used, unverified
L2MN-DEMO_CATI_R05_-_all_versions_-_False_-_2026-11-06-18-00-00.csv (E01)	platform records	E01	127	used, unverified
L2MN-DEMO_CATI_R05_-_all_versions_-_False_-_2026-11-06-18-00-00.csv (E02)	platform records	E02	86	used, unverified

No merge question is open.

Figure C2. Step 3 with the Philippines-layout export added: the export split by interviewer and merged as unverified exports.

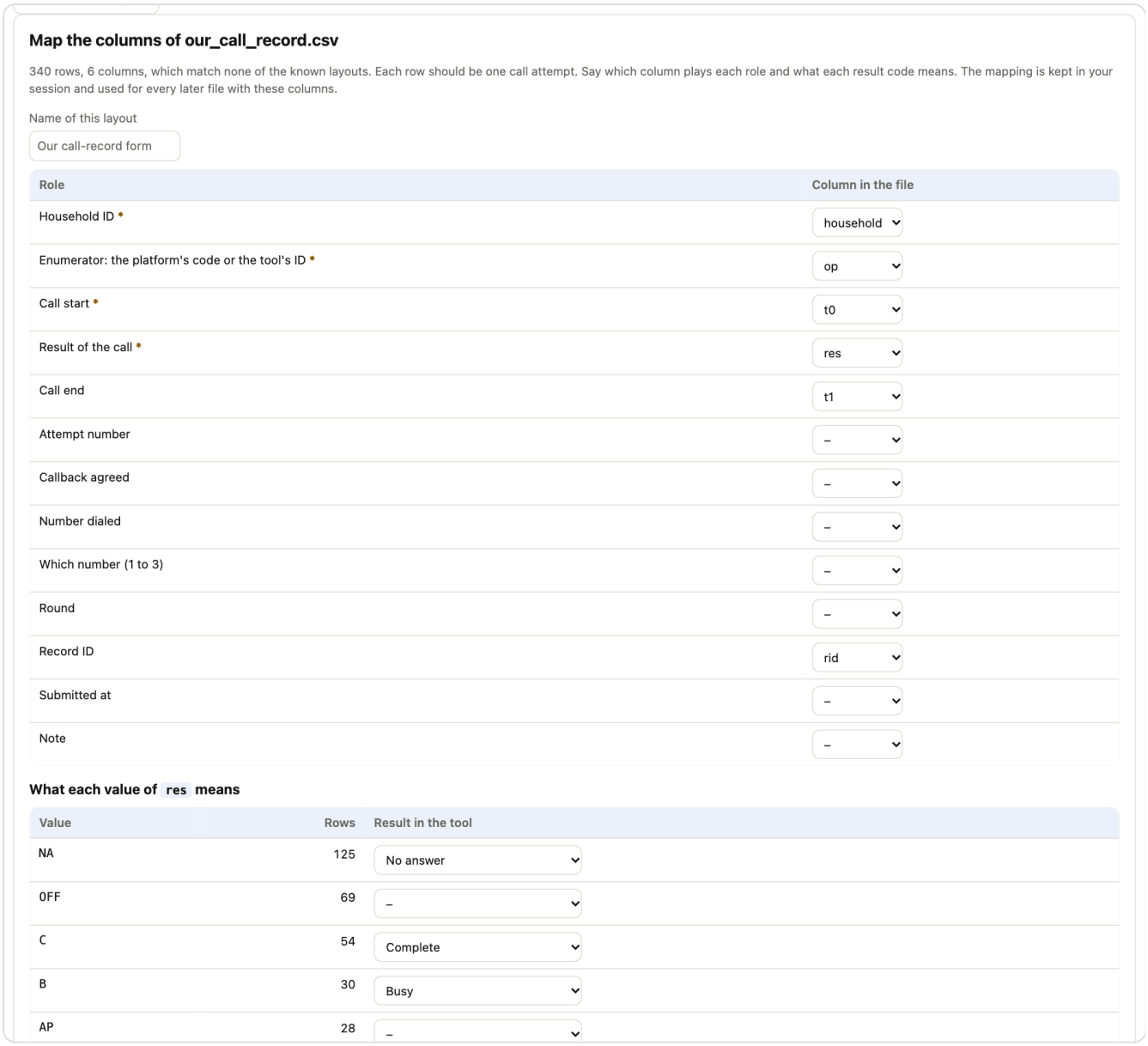


Figure C3. The mapping card for a file whose columns the tool does not know: the roles, and what each value of the result column means.

The samples: `samples/kobo/` holds the synthetic program's round-5 calls in the Philippines layout (340 submissions, the same calls as the exports of Part B), the choices list the tool writes for it, and the tool's own form's files. Every phone number uses the invalid country code +000.

Part D · With Survey Solutions

When enumerators interview in Survey Solutions rather than in this tool

D1 When this part applies

Survey Solutions gives work out by assignment: an interviewer can open interviews only from an assignment made to their login, and each interview then passes through review (completed, approved or rejected by the supervisor, then by headquarters). The tool keeps what Survey Solutions does not know: the round, the plan, the dial cap, the moves and the round's call log. The **Survey Solutions** tab walks the cycle in five steps (Figure D1): the questionnaire and the interviewers' logins (1); the assignments upload before the round (2); the export each day (3); the moves to make in Headquarters (4); and the interviews to look at (5).

Step 1 is the codes table of the KoBoToolbox tab (C1): the code is the interviewer's login, read whatever its case or punctuation, and a code entered on either tab is the same entry. Step 2 names any enumerator still without a login before it writes the file, because Headquarters refuses a login it does not know. What a program needs: its questionnaire, with its calls either as a roster or as one interview per call attempt; the household list in the tool's columns (B3); the team (B7) with each interviewer's login; and, for a questionnaire the tool does not know, two answers once (D3). The cycle was run once on a Survey Solutions demo server (release 26.11, 10 November 2026) with the synthetic round: the upload, six web interviews, a rejection, two reassignments and the export, read back by the tool. What that run showed is folded into this part and into `formats/suso/README.md`.

D2 The tool's own questionnaire

For a program without a phone questionnaire, `formats/suso/README.md` specifies one to build once in Designer: one interview per household, its cover page the household's identifying fields (the ID, the name and the numbers first: the tablet's dashboard card shows the first three, the web interviewer's dashboard all of them), and a roster `calls` with one row per call: the number dialed, the call's start and end (timestamps), the result in the tool's codes (1 to 14, and 99 for a record without a call), the willingness to take part, a callback, an action and a note.

Before the round, step 2 writes **assignments.tab** from the current manifest: one row per household and released reserve, the identifying fields, the login in `_responsible` and 1 in `_quantity`. Upload it in Headquarters under Survey Setup › Questionnaires › the questionnaire › Upload assignments. Headquarters matches each login against the account exactly as it was created, capitals included: a login that differs only in case is refused as unknown and the whole file with it, so the logins of step 1 must be spelled as Headquarters shows them. The file holds phone numbers, which go to the Survey Solutions server and nowhere else.

Each day, export the questionnaire in Headquarters (Data Export, Tab separated, all statuses), and add the zip under **Add the export (.zip)** in step 3 (Figure D2). The browser opens the zip (the Stata do-files and the questionnaire folder in it are ignored). The tool joins each call to its interview and gives it to the interviewer who held the interview when the call started. It finds that in `interview__actions`, so a household reassigned between two calls keeps its first calls with the first interviewer. The tool then splits the export by interviewer and merges each part as a CSV export (B13). A timestamp is written in the tablet's time zone without an offset, and the tool places it in the round's zone. A complete needs a call of three minutes or more, from its start to its end.

Step 3 also says what the export holds: the interviews by their status in Survey Solutions, how many were held by more than one interviewer, how many carry validation errors, and which the supervisor or headquarters rejected. A rejected interview is read as it stands and its complete still counts, since the interviewer corrects and resubmits it; the merge report notes it, household by household. A deleted interview is left out.

D3 A questionnaire the tool does not know

A program's own questionnaire is read in two answers, each given once and kept in the session. First, step 3 asks which file of the export holds the calls (Figure D3): the interviews themselves, when each call attempt is an interview of its own (assignments of unlimited quantity, `_quantity` –1 in step 2); a roster of calls inside the interview; or neither, when the questionnaire records interviews only and the team logs its calls in the tool. Second, the mapping card of C3 opens with the export's own columns already chosen: the interviewer (`suso__interviewer`), the record (`suso__record`, the interview key) and, where the questionnaire has no call times, the interview's first answer and completion. Choose the household ID and the result, and say what each result value means. For such a questionnaire step 2 writes the household ID alone, under the name of its variable.

D4 A round, day by day

1. **Before the round.** Prepare it as in B3 to B10, with each interviewer's login. Upload `assignments.tab` (step 2).
2. **Each day.** Add the latest export in step 3. Progress (B15), the call log (B16) and the analytics (B17) follow, and the merge questions of B13 are raised where they apply.
3. **Part-way through.** Move households on the Progress tab (B15). Step 4 then lists each moved household with the login before and after, the assignment ID and any interview keys: reassign them in Headquarters (Assignments, filter by the old login, tick, Assign; an interview already started under Interviews, the same way), in one batch a day. The list's **In Headquarters** column reads the latest export: *done* once it shows the assignment or an interview passed to the new login after the move, *pending* until then, and *no interview yet* for a household the export holds no interview of: the export's assignment history covers only households with an interview, so until then the Assignments list in Headquarters is the place to confirm the move. Its **Received** column says whether a tablet already holds the work: Survey Solutions warns that reassigning such work can make extra interviews and asks for a confirmation (web interviewing never shows it). A call the previous interviewer makes after the move is flagged as a double call.
4. **When a merge question concerns an interview.** Step 5 lists the calls behind it by their record: the interview key, and the roster row after `#`. Search the key under Interviews and reject the interview with a comment when a call should be corrected.
5. **Next round.** As in C4: the merged call log and actions file are the next round's history.

D5 What the leader sees

1 · The questionnaire and the interviewers' logins

For a team that interviews in Survey Solutions rather than in this tool's enumerator view: the tool's own questionnaire (`formats/suso/README.md` : one interview per household, the calls a roster), or a program's own questionnaire whose calls are a roster or whose interviews are one per call attempt. The tool keeps the leader's side: the assignment, the plan, the merge, progress and the moves during the round. What crosses the boundary is a file each way: the assignments go to Headquarters (2), the export comes in each day (3), moves follow (4), and the interviews to look at go back (5).

Enumerator	Login in Survey Solutions (the interviewer's user name)
E01	CATI01
E02	CATI02
E07	CATI07

Empty means the enumerator's ID itself. Several codes for one interviewer, separated by commas, are all read as that interviewer (a typing slip, an old code); the first is written into the assignments file (_responsible). The platform's records are read under the tool's ID through the code, whatever its case or punctuation. A code entered before the files are written goes into the manifest (Prepare tab, step 5, shows the same column); one entered later is kept in this session. The KoBoToolbox and Survey Solutions tabs share this list.

2 · Before the round: the assignments go to Headquarters

Questionnaire: the tool's own (every column) | Variable of the household ID: hhid | Interviews per assignment: 1: the calls are a roster in the interview

assignments.tab (110 households and up to 34 reserves) — has phone numbers

One assignment per household and listed reserve, from the current manifest, the interviewer's login in `_responsible` and the number of interviews in `_quantity` . In Headquarters: Survey Setup › Questionnaires › the questionnaire › Upload assignments. Headquarters checks three things before it accepts the file: every column is a variable of the questionnaire (download its template there to compare the names), every row has a login in `_responsible` , and each login exists with the interviewer or supervisor role, **spelled exactly as the account was created, capitals included** (a login that differs only in case is refused as unknown, so type the logins in step 1 as Headquarters shows them). The upload page also asks for a default responsible; it applies only to rows without one. With the tool's own questionnaire every column is one, so the interviewer sees the household's name, numbers and planned first call on the dashboard: the numbers go to the Survey Solutions server, which keeps them as it keeps the answers. With a program's own questionnaire the file carries the household ID alone, under its variable's name, and the interviewer takes the numbers from the questionnaire's own preload.

Figure D1. The Survey Solutions tab, steps 1 and 2: the interviewers' logins, the questionnaire's settings and the assignments upload.

3 · Each day: the export

In Headquarters: Data Export, the questionnaire, **Tab separated**, all statuses (or those you follow), then download the zip and add it whole (its Stata do-files and questionnaire folder are ignored). The tool reads the main file, the roster that holds the calls and three service files: `interview__actions` says which interviewer held each interview when (a household moved during the round keeps its calls with the interviewer who made them), `interview__diagnostics` who is responsible for it, and `assignment__actions` who holds each assignment and whether a tablet has received it. The export is cumulative: add the latest zip, and the tool splits it by interviewer and merges each part as it merges the enumerators' CSV exports, every merge question raised where it applies. A questionnaire the tool does not know is read once you say which file holds the calls and map its columns.

Add the export (.zip) — Remove all 5 files

File	Kind	Enumerator	Rows	Used
rtm_call_record_1_Tabular_All.zip › calls	RTM call record (Survey Solutions questionnaire)		342	107 interviews, 342 call records, split into 3 exports by enumerator
rtm_call_record_1_Tabular_All.zip › calls (E01)	Survey Solutions records	E01	127	used, unverified
rtm_call_record_1_Tabular_All.zip › calls (E02)	Survey Solutions records	E02	87	used, unverified
rtm_call_record_1_Tabular_All.zip › calls (E07)	Survey Solutions records	E07	128	used, unverified

What rtm_call_record_1_Tabular_All.zip says of its 107 interviews

Status in Survey Solutions	Interviews
Interviewer assigned	53
Completed	53
Rejected by supervisor	1

No interview held by more than one interviewer; none with validation errors; **1 interview rejected** (04-74-10-22): their calls are read as recorded and are noted in the merge report; 144 assignments in assignment__actions.

No merge question is open.

Figure D2. Step 3 with the sample export added: 107 interviews holding 342 call records, split by interviewer and merged.

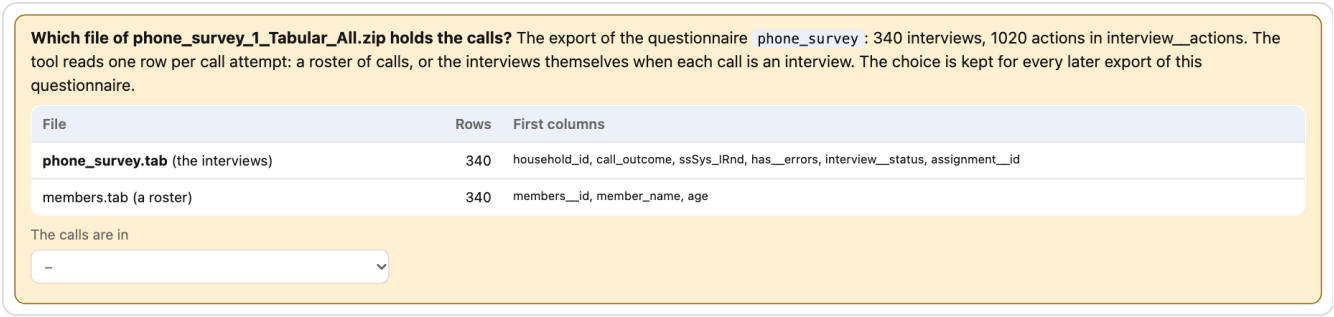


Figure D3. An export the tool does not know: which of its files holds the calls.

The samples: `samples/suso/` holds the synthetic program's round-5 calls as an export of the tool's own questionnaire (the same calls as the exports of Part B and the samples of Part C) and the assignments upload. Every phone number uses the invalid country code +000.

Reference

R1 Call results

Result	Code	Use it when
Complete	`COMPLETE`	The interview was completed (3 minutes or more counts, Box 3.0)
Appointment booked	`APPOINTMENT`	The respondent agreed a time: enter it as the callback time
Partial interview	`PARTIAL`	The interview started but did not finish
Respondent not available	`NOT_AVAILABLE`	Someone answered, but not the respondent
No answer	`NO_ANSWER`	The phone rang without an answer
Busy	`BUSY`	The line was busy
Switched off / unreachable	`SWITCHED_OFF`	The phone was off or out of reach
Our number is blocked	`BLOCKED`	The respondent's phone rejects your number at once: your leader can move the household to a colleague
Number not in service	`DEAD_NUMBER`	The number does not exist or is disconnected
Wrong number	`WRONG_NUMBER`	The number is not the household's
Refusal (may retry)	`REFUSAL_SOFT`	A refusal for now; a later call may succeed
Refusal (do not retry)	`REFUSAL_HARD`	A firm refusal: release the household for the round
Language barrier	`LANGUAGE`	The respondent and you share no language
Other (write a note)	`OTHER`	None of the above; a note is required

R2 Why a household is with an enumerator

Reason	What the enumerator reads
`keep`	Kept with you: you interviewed it last round (or in an earlier round, or you had it last round)
`rotation`	Rotation: part of the planned share moved between enumerators
`switch_hard_to_reach`	Switched to you: hard to reach with the previous enumerator
`enumerator_unavailable`	Moved to you: the previous enumerator is away
`new`	New to the panel
`rule`	Dealt to you at random, or placed with you by a block of the list, by the round's rule
`manual`	Assigned by hand
`capacity`	Moved to balance workloads

`match`	Matched to you by your leader's criteria (language, sex or area), with the household's values
`mid_round`	Moved to you during the round from another enumerator, so that the round finishes on time
`replacement`	Replacement household

R3 Every file the tool reads or writes

File	Written by	Read by	Folder	Contacts?
Household list (`.csv` or `.xlsx`)	The program	Leader	Leader's own	Yes
`selection.csv` or a replacement list	The sampling tool or the program	Leader	Leader's own	No
`E07_assignment_R05.json`	Leader	Enumerator E07	E07's own	Yes, E07's households only
`L2MN-DEMO_R05_manifest.json`	Leader	Leader (merge)	Leader's own	No
`E07_project_R05.json` (saved session)	Enumerator	Enumerator	E07's own	Yes
`E07_2026-10-27.csv` and `.json` (export)	Enumerator	Leader	Common	No
`E07_2026-10-27_contacts.json`	Enumerator	Leader	Given to the leader directly	Yes
`leader_L2MN-DEMO_R05.json` (leader session)	Leader	Leader	Leader's own	Yes
`_calls.csv` , `_actions.csv` , `interviews.csv` , `calendar.csv` , `outcome_codes.csv` , `_merge_report.csv`	Leader	The handbook's scripts and template; next round's leader	Leader's own	No
`_contact_updates.csv`	Leader	Leader	Leader's own	Yes
A KoBoToolbox form's export, one submission per call attempt (Part C)	KoBoToolbox	Leader (KoBoToolbox tab)	Leader's own	Usually yes: never the common folder
A Survey Solutions export (`.zip` , Part D)	Survey Solutions	Leader (Survey Solutions tab)	Leader's own	Usually yes: never the common folder

`choices_households.csv`, `households.csv`, `assignments.tab`	Leader	The platform	Given to the platform only	All but the choices list
`_suso_moves.csv`, `_kobo_review.csv`, `_suso_review.csv`	Leader	Leader	Leader's own	No
`_risk_dropout.csv`, `_risk_return.csv`	Leader	Leader	Leader's own	No

The file formats are defined in `formats/README.md`, and `formats/check_formats.py` checks any file against them.